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This self-organization is available to units being in space. **Hence, for space, we say 'self organization is available'.**

To sum up

- There are two kinds of realities in existence: space and units in space.
- These units are in co-existence with space and in co-existence amongst themselves .
- We can thus understand the whole of existence as Nature submerged in Space. We can understand this harmony.
- Each unit is
  - ❖ **energised and active in space**
  - ❖ **self-organized in space**
  - ❖ **recognizing and fulfilling its relationship with other units in space**
- Space is in continuum. It is all-pervading and is no-activity.
- We are also units in space and there is acceptance in us (in 'I') for self-organization.

'Existence is Co-existence'

Now that we have studied ourselves, our family, society, nature and space, let us see the interconnectedness between all these units and space. We find that being in space, the units are mutually fulfilling to other units. This is being in co-existence.

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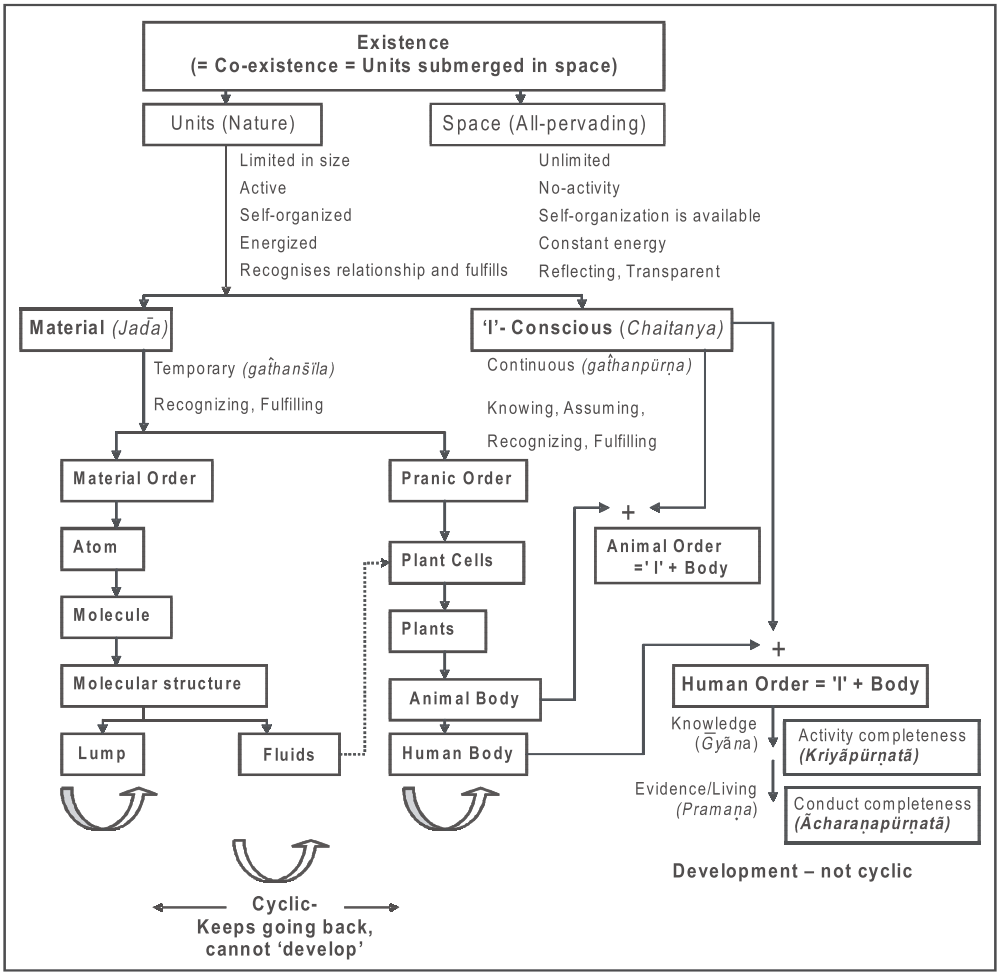

The figure above depicts all the four orders (material, plant/bio, animal and human) and their co-existence with space. We have already covered the relationship between units and space in the previous section. We saw that units co-exist in space or units are submerged in space. In this section, we shall explore into units and see how they are inter-related in existence.

** You keep referring to the figure above as you read through the rest of this section.*

Material and conscious units

You will see in the figure above that we have categorized units into two types:

- Material or *jaḍa*
- Conscious or *chaitanya*

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What does this mean? We have already been discussing this, so let's go over it:

Material units are those that are only *recognizing* and *fulfilling*. There is no *assuming* in them. There is no potential in them to *know or assume*. Everything in the material order: stones, minerals, soil, petrol, etc; everything in the plant/bio order: plants, shrubs, grass, animal body and human body fall into this category of 'Material' or *jaḍa* kind of units. It is interesting. If we consider the animal and human body, we find that there is only recognition and fulfilment. There is no assuming in the animal and human body.

We had discussed about this in chapter five. Let us recapitulate it. Taking an example, suppose you take a blade and cut your finger. If the blade is sharper than your skin then the skin gets cut and will bleed. No matter how many times you try this. If you ask a friend to do this, the result is the same. The skin does not respond in different ways depending on who is cutting it. But what happens at the level of the Self, where *assumption* is involved. Let's say you have gone to the doctor's clinic and the doctor takes a blade to make a cut in your skin. Since you know that you have gone to the doctor to be treated, you cooperate with the doctor and allow him/her to make a cut on your skin. Now, if you assume that the person is not a doctor, you are sitting in a bus and someone takes a knife and tries to cut your skin, what would you do? You would be alarmed and resist the person. Of course, if he succeeds in putting a knife to your skin, your skin will still bleed!

It becomes clear, that

At the level of the body there is only recognizing and fulfilment,

At the level of 'I', there is assuming and knowing, in addition to recognizing and fulfilment..

As indicated earlier, we call 'I' (*Jivana*) a conscious entity or *chaitanya* or consciousness. We call the body material or *jaḍa*. Each one of us can distinguish the units around us based on this categorization. Why are we doing this? Simple: to better understand the things we live with, including ourselves!

If we understood which units assume and which don't, then we would know how to interact with them. In our interactions with the material order, such as a stone, we know that there is no assumption involved, and we can be assured of its behaviour. While interacting with animals or humans, we know that there is assumption involved, and hence keeping this in consideration, we can improve our interaction and relationship.

Thus, Material or 'jaḍa' units:

- Have the activities of recognizing & fulfilment.
- Are *temporary* in nature, they undergo *structural* changes. We also call them *gaṭhanīśila*.

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Conscious or chaitanya units:

- Have the activities of knowing, assuming, recognizing & fulfilment. Currently, assuming, recognizing and fulfilment are predominant in humans. We have the *capacity* to know, and we explored this via our natural acceptance. 'Knowing' means having the 'right understanding', understanding the harmony at all four levels of our being.
- Are *continuous*, there is *no structural change in them*. There can only be a qualitative change in them. We also call them *gaṭhanpurṇa*.

Material units: from atoms to the human body

Now that we have explored that basic classification in units, let us explore into the material (*jaḍa)* units. Material Units are the basis for all material things – soil, metal, rocks, liquids, gases to the basic cells and all the way to animal and human bodies. The material units undergo changes through physical and physico-chemical processes. In the material order, an atom combines with another atom to form molecular structure. The molecular structures can exist either as lumps *(pinda),* or fluids (*rasa*). Fluids are the basis of a plant cell (*pranic* order) and such cells combine to form plants, the animal body and the human body. Thus, we can see that in the material units, starting from the smallest fundamental particle that is stable, the atom, a sequence of natural events takes place, and solids (like stones, minerals, etc.), fluids (like water, fossil oil, etc.), plant cells (that go on to form the innumerable variety of plants we know of), animal bodies (of various species) and finally the human body, (in which we find a lot of variety in physical appearance) – all these are formed. All these processes are taking place in a self-organized, natural manner. *There is nothing controlling these processes*, these processes occur naturally in co-existence.

These events, these processes starting from the atom all the way to the highly complex human body are all happening in a *self-organized manner*. We humans are not *creating these processes or units, neither are we responsible for controlling* this entire process. When we understand this self-organisation, we are also able to understand our relationship with them and its fulfilment.

Conscious (sentient) units, the animal order and the human order

We have been talking about the material units so far, up to the animal and human bodies. What of animals and human beings? What else is left to have an animal and human being, the way we know them? The answer is: conscious/ sentient units! We also referred to these units as the Self or ('I'). We have already discussed that animals and human beings are as co-existence of the conscious/sentient ('I') unit and the material body. We have been exploring this in the chapters so far.

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Animals or Animal Order = 'I' + Animal Body

Humans or Human Order = 'I' + Human Body

What is my role in existence?

Let us do the following: Take a look at the picture of existence we have a few pages earlier. Now answer these questions for yourself:

What have I done for any of these to exist?

What have I done for space to exist?

What have I done for material and conscious units to exist?

What have I done for atoms, molecules, lumps, fluids, and plants to exist?

What have I done for animals and humans to exist?

What have I done for the existence of my own body? My teeth, hands, eyes, feet, etc?

What I have done for my own existence?

Have I created any of this at all?

Am I controlling or directing any of this at all?

Am I the one directing the formation of molecules, the growth of plants, or the beating of my own heart?

We are not doing any of these. We are not creating any of these!

What is my role in this existence then, if I have not created, or am not controlling any of these?

All I can do is learn to live with all this! And how would this learning be possible? This is what we have been discussing from the beginning of this book: understanding the harmony at all four levels of our living. This is happiness; this ensures the continuity of happiness in us. When we are able to have the right understanding, we live with the understanding and are hence able to fulfil our relationship with the four orders.

We have been discussing the need to have the understanding of harmony at all four levels of existence so far. The detail of this is as follows:

Existence is Co-existence. Co-existence is in the form of:

Every unit is submerged in space (Harmony in Existence)

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Every unit is related and mutuallly
fulfilling to every other unit (Harmony in Nature)

Human being is related and wants to be
mutually fulfilling to every other unit (Harmony in Society)

'I' is related and wants to be mutually
fulfilling to every 'I' (Harmony in family)

'I' is related and wants to be mutually
fulfilling to Body (Harmony with Body)

Different activities in 'I' are also interrelated
and active to be in harmony (Harmony in 'I')

(realisation and understanding ensure harmony in desires, thoughts, expectations)

Understanding the self ('I'), the activities in 'I', and their interrelation, understanding the reality of 'I' as being distinct from the body is called **knowledge of Self ('I').**

The knowledge of Self ('I') or *Jïvana* is called *jïvana ¯gyãna.*

Understanding the harmony at all the levels above means we have understood existence.

This is called knowledge of Existence or we also call it *astitva darshana ¯gyãna.*

Having understood 'I' *(jïvana)* and the entire existence, we understand our relationship with every unit in existence and fulfil it, leading to mutual happiness and prosperity.

This is called knowledge of human(e) conduct, also called *mãnavïyatã pürṇa acharaṇa ¯gyãna .*

The knowledge of these three put together is called right understanding: understanding of existence, understanding of the Self, and understanding human(e) conduct. This is the same as understanding the harmony at all four levels of our existence.

When we have this right understanding, the activities of 1) Realization and 2) Understanding – which are currently dormant in 'I' also get expressed, ***hence we also call this 'activity completeness' or 'kriyãpurṇatã '.*** All the activities in 'I' are now expressed, not only desiring, thinking and selection, as is the case now.

When there is completeness in the ability of 'I' to live with right understanding at all the four levels, leading to mutual fulfilment, ***it is called 'conduct completeness' or 'ãcharanpurnatã'.***

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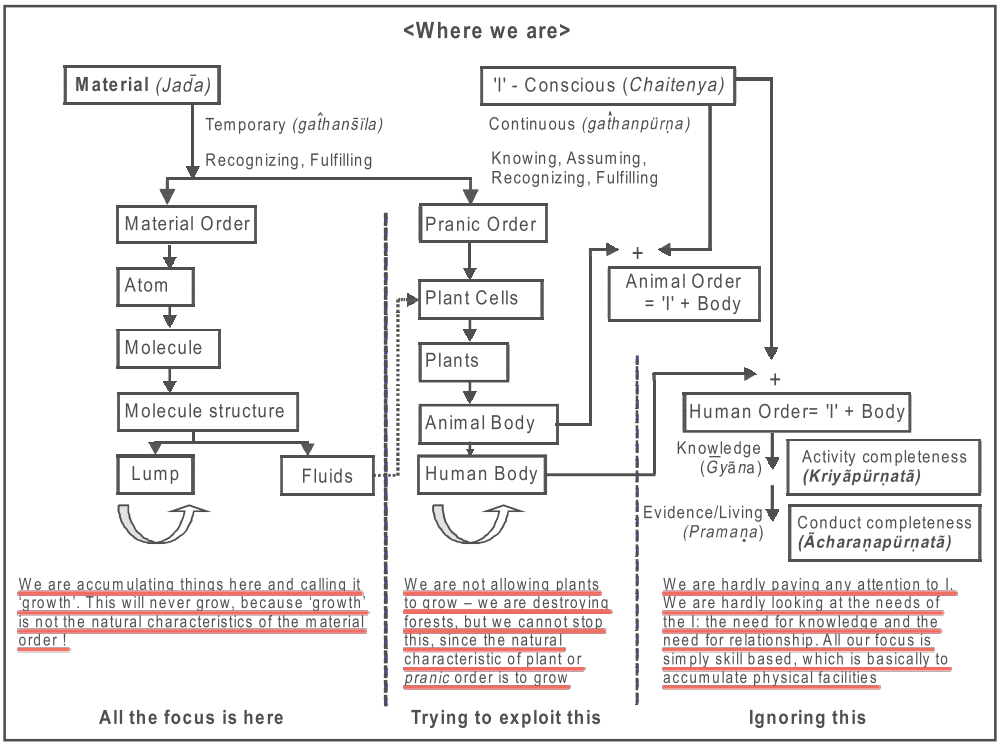
Thus, we can see that each material and conscious unit is submerged in space and being in space, each unit is energised, self-organized and recognizes and fulfils its relationships with other entities. This is the entirety of existence and it is harmonious.

So, Existence is in the form of Co-existence. It is in Harmony. We don't have to *create* this harmony, it already exists. We only have to *understand* it to be in it. This means that having the knowledge of existence and knowledge of self ('I') gives me the knowledge of humane conduct (*how to live in existence, with the four orders*). With this knowledge, I can live with humane conduct. This is the pending task we have to complete!

What are we Doing Today?

"Growing what does not grow", "stopping what anyway grows"!

Look at the diagram below:



* We are trying to grow in the left side (material order) and somehow trying to stop growth on the right side (plant order) –which does not.

We can understand the basic nature of all units. We can understand the natural characteristic of an order, and then know what to do with it. For example:

Material Order – is characterized by composition-decomposition. This is its natural characteristic, its participation. It does not 'grow'. i.e. stones do not 'grow', gold does not 'grow', money; the paper it is printed on does not 'grow'.

Plant/*Pranic* Order - is characterized by growth and maintaining the form of growth. Ex: a plant grows, a shrub grows.

Now, if you want 'growth', would you focus on material order, or on the plant order? The answer seems obvious: if we wanted growth, we would look towards the order that has growth as its 'natural characteristic' and work on it. We find that this is in the plant order as in existence, naturally, without us having to do anything about it, plants or the plant order anyway grows.

Now, if you look at the diagram we have above, you will find that today we are putting all efforts into the material order. All the 'growth' we talk of is here: by making more cars, eating more chocolate, building more roads, making bigger buildings and robots, we think we are 'growing'. *But this is not possible, since by its natural characteristic itself, the material order does not grow!* Howsoever, we try for growth here, we *cannot* be satisfied, because at the end of the day, it is only **accumulation**. *Hence, we can accumulate money, but we cannot grow money!* On the other hand, that which naturally grows i.e. plants, we are trying to stop! We seem to be trying very hard to stop the growth in plants today!

Thus, our attempts at growth are quite mixed up today. There is an inherent problem in the kind of 'growth' we are talking about. We are focusing on the material order or *padārtha avasthā* which does not grow and not paying attention to the plant order or *prāṇa avasthā*, which anyways grows. We don't have to do anything for it! This is because we do not have the right understanding. We do not understand the natural characteristic of these orders and *our actions are not aligned according to the natural characteristics of these orders.* Thus, when we talk about growth now, we are not really 'growing', we are only 'accumulating'. And that is the reason for the problem. Today, we think, we all have to struggle to survive; that if I have to have growth, or what I am trying to grow does not grow by natural design, I have to snatch it away from the other. Thus, we only end up having a lot of competition, and no growth in the real sense. Now, if you wanted growth you would plant trees, say, a banana tree. In a few years it would have grown so much that you will have more than you can manage. There is growth taking place in existence anyway, even if we don't initiate it, there is no need to compete for it.

It is also clear that we are ignoring the needs of the Self ('I') and mainly focusing on physical facilities, which are in the material order.

Accumulation in the material order cannot be a substitute for the needs of knowledge/ understanding and relationship in 'I'. Work on the material order needs to be done in the *light* of understanding in 'I' and the needs of 'I'.

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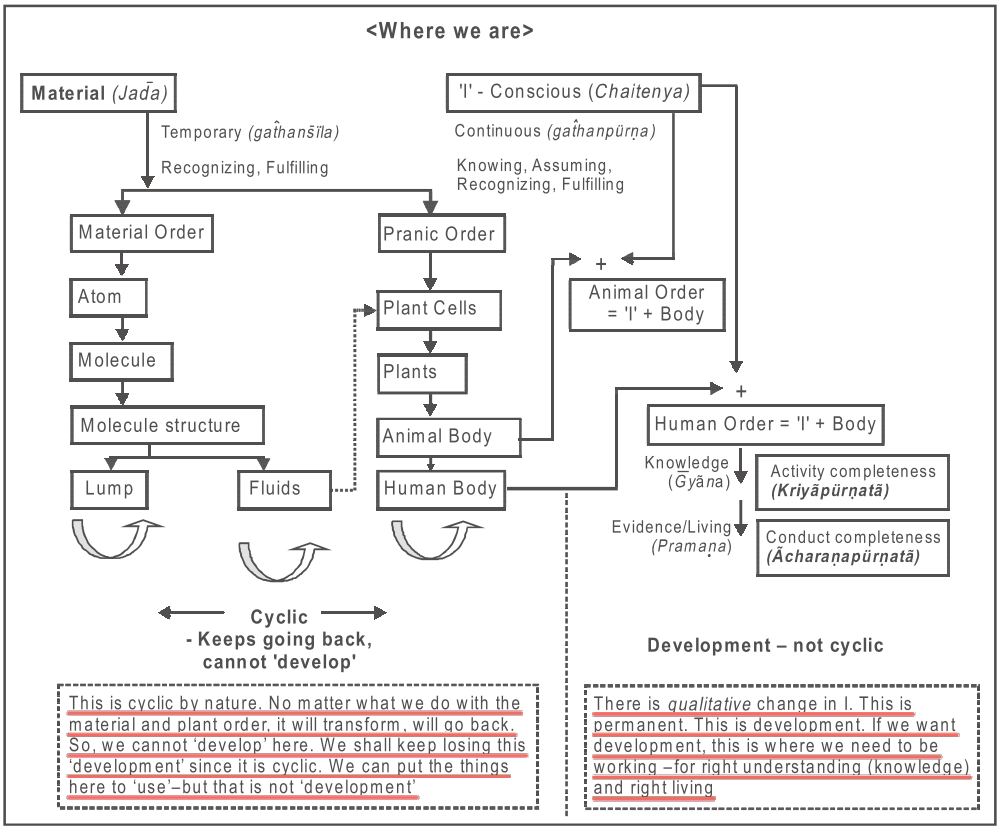
"Developing where it cycles back", "not developing where it does not"

Let's start with a question:

If you had 'development', would you want it to be reversible or irreversible? Whatever you gained out of development, would you want it to stay, or go away/back to where you started from?

The answer, one can guess, is we want development to be irreversible, to stay with us, to be permanent. So, if something we do is in a cycle, i.e. if we go back to where we started from, we would not call it 'development'. Take a look at the figure below:



What we are doing today in the name of 'development' is to focus on the material order and the plant order. Now, by nature, these are cyclic. They undergo composition/ decomposition. Hence, if we work on this order, it is in a cycle, it is not 'development', each time going back to where we started from!

Where does 'development' take place then? Development has to take place in the human being – in 'I', by knowing the reality, knowing the entire existence and living in accordance with it.

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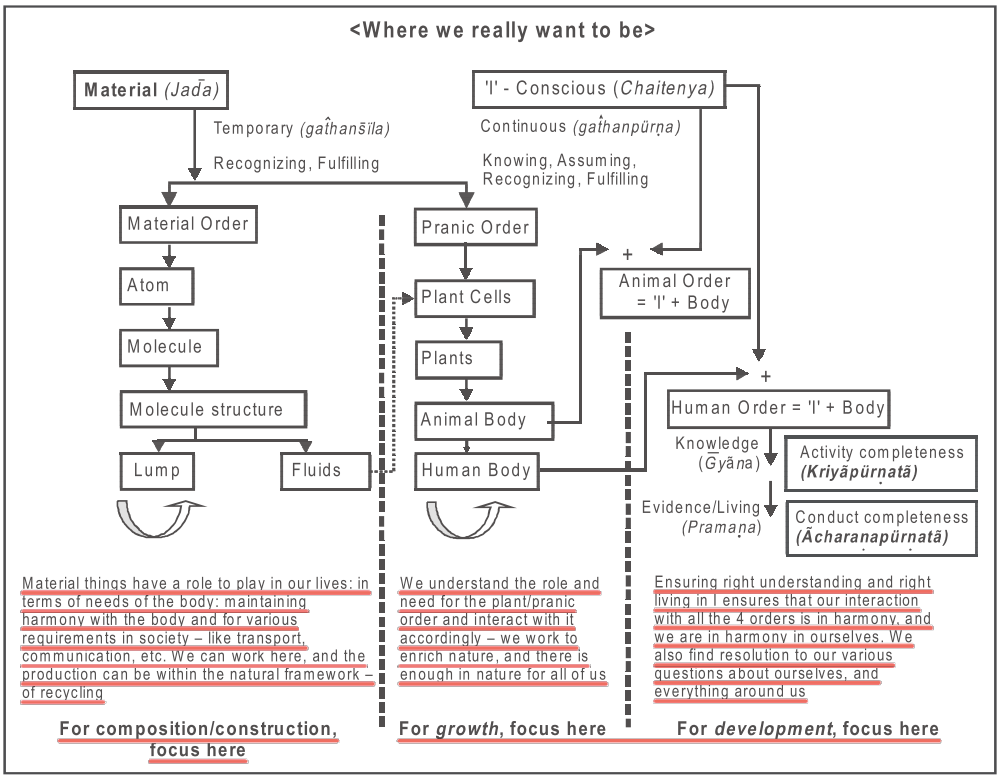
Where do we want to be?

We want to interact with the material order with a view to make things that remain as constructed, like our houses, implements. We want to use them for composition. We want to use plant order where growth is required. And for ourselves, we want to develop as responsible human beings. This is depicted in the diagram below:



Summary

- There are two kinds of realities in existence: units, and space. Space is a reality and can be understood.
- The units are in co-existence being in space.
- We can thus understand the whole of existence as *Nature submerged in Space.*
- The units are limited, active, energised, recognize and fulfil the relationship with other units, and self-organized. Space is all-pervading, no-activity, equilibrium energy, reflecting (transparent), and, self-organization is available in space.

- Existence is co-existence. Being in space, the units are in harmony, and fulfil the relationship with each other. This can be understood for all the four orders.
- My role in existence is only to understand the co-existence to reach the state of *kriyāpürṇatā* * and live accordingly to attain *ācharaṇpürṇatā* *.
- With lack of right understanding, we are investing ourselves to grow things that do not grow, develop things where it cycles back.
- We need to work on the material order for composition or construction, on plant order for growth and for development, we need to work for right understanding.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. "Existence = Nature submerged in space"- Elaborate this point.
2. Differentiate between units and space. How are units self-organized in space?
3. What do you mean by co-existence? How are units in co-existence being in space?
4. Draw the chart showing in detail, the different categories of units of nature in co-existence in space. What is your role in Existence?
5. Where is the scope of development in nature? How have we come to wrongly place our developmental programs?
6. What is the role of material order and bio-order in the fulfilment of human needs? How does understanding of existence help in right identification of the above?
7. How will the understanding of harmony in Existence influence the R&D programs in science and technology?

* Can be spelt as *Kriyapoornata* and *Acharanpoornata* respectively too.

SECTION III

IMPLICATIONS OF THE RIGHT UNDERSTANDING

This Section Contains:

Chapter 12: Providing the Basis for Universal Human Values and Ethical Human Conduct

Chapter 13: Basis for the Holistic Alternative towards Universal Human Order

Chapter 14: Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Chapter 15: Vision for Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

Chapter 16: Journey towards the Holistic Alternative: The Road Ahead

CHAPTER TWELVE

Providing the Basis for Universal Human Values and Ethical Human Conduct

In section-II, we explored the content of right understanding, discovering the innate harmony at various levels of existence right from the human being to the whole of existence. This included a correct appraisal of the needs, characteristics and activities of the self ('I') and the Body and also the salient aspects of synergy between these. Then we also understood human-to-human relationships and the values characterising these relationships leading to harmony in family and society. We went further to explore the inherent interconnectedness, cyclability, self-regulation and mutual fulfilment existing in Nature. Finally, we concluded this study by identifying co-existence in the entire existence. This manifests in the form harmonious interaction of units (both sentient and insentient i.e consciousness and material) with each other being in co-existence with the all-pervading space. This reality- 'space' is no-activity, transparent, equilibrium energy and the units of nature are 'submerged' in space. Being in space, they are energized, self-organized and fulfil the definite relationship with each other, leading to the complete existential order-'*samagra vyavasthã*'.

All the above investigations were carried out through a process of self-exploration and studying the things around us. While the process of self-exploration has to continue to enable realization and understanding, we can start looking at the significant implications of such an understanding in our life and profession. This forms the subject matter of the five chapters of this section.

Here we can also visualize how such an understanding of the truth of existence and our ability to live in accordance with it, can pave way towards collective and sustainable human happiness and prosperity. Such an understanding enables the human being to achieve harmony in oneself, harmony with other human beings and harmony with rest of nature. This unfolding of truth through the process of self-exploration seems to be the direction of evolution of the entire mankind. This also is the purpose of human life. It is for us to get adequately convinced through our own exploration, that this is the only effective way of establishing peace within as well as peace outside.

In this section, we will also be able to visualize how the right understanding provides us the vision for carving out the 'Holistic Alternative' and perpetuate it in the human tradition in contrast to the present indefinite and highly unsustainable model of human living. It also provides the basis for ethical conduct of profession in a natural way and the development of appropriate technologies, production systems and management models to facilitate the holistic way of life. So let us start appreciating these implications and also visualize how we could undertake the journey towards the 'Holistic Alternative'.

Values in Different Dimensions of Human Living

We studied the harmony at the four levels of human living in section-II. Based on this understanding of harmony, when we participate in the larger order, this participation at different level is our value. The identification of values starts from the participation of the activities of the Self ('I') in the form of definite conduct of the human being based on realization and understanding. Further, the participation of the human being is seen in two forms: behaviour and work. We studied about the values pertaining to behaviour as the nine values in relationship, - viz., trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory and love. Since we discussed them in detail in chapter 8, we will not discuss them here.

Likewise, working with material things, we have two values:

Utility-value: The participation of a human being in ensuring the role of physical facility in nurture, protection and providing means for the body.

Artistic-value: The participation of a human being in ensuring the role of physical facility to help and preserve its utility.

For example, the utility value of a pen is that it aids in writing. This provides a means to the body. Providing a cap to the pen so that the ink does not spill, a proper design for holding of the pen while writing, etc. preserve the utility of the pen. A shirt has the utility that it protects the body. This is its utility value. Designing the shirt so that it can be easily put on is the artistic value. Thus we provide buttons in the front, the size of the shirt is as per the size of the body and so on. Similarly, with food, we find that the utility of the food is that it helps nurture the body. But cooking the food in such a way, that it can be easily chewed and swallowed, served in the dish, etc. is the artistic value. Taking the example of a book, when we are printing a book, it adds utility to the paper. The content that is printed helps us store it for a longer time so that we could refer to it from time to time. If you have to memorise everything, it is going to be a huge engagement for you. But printing it on paper saves our energy and time. This is utility value. Now keeping the font size so that the book is legible, designing its size so that it is easy to carry it, etc. is adding artistic value to the book.

One important point to be noted here is that artistic value is there only when utility value is there. When there is no utility, it has no scope for art too.

In appendix II, we have listed some more values for you to familiarize. You will see that all these values are nothing but the participation of the human being in different dimensions of living.

Universal Values Naturally Emerging from the Right Understanding

Let us now understand how the inculcation of universal values is a natural outcome of the right understanding. From the discussions of section-II, we can easily infer that there is an innate harmony and orderliness in the existence. The human beings only need to understand it (and not to create it). The universal human urge for happiness and prosperity is actually the quest for understanding this harmony and being in tune with it. The universal human values are the parameters which designate this harmony at various levels and highlight the universal purpose in terms of understanding this harmony. Thus, the universal human values are nothing but manifestation of the truth of existence (harmony, co-existence) in various dimensions of human interaction in terms of the participation in the universal order. These are naturally acceptable to all human beings and conducive to human happiness. Only our ignorance, our wrong pre-conditionings, our illusion about ourselves, about the existence, about the nature of sensory interactions and about our relationships with things around us, leads to all the difficulties and confusions in appreciating and inculcating these universal values. Continuous self-observation and self-exploration into entire existence enables us to realize this truth. We are able to appreciate the universality and the innateness of human being. On our own right, we can experience how such a realization leads to fulfilment at all levels. Once we are able to get rid of our false pre-conditioning and anchor ourselves to our natural acceptance, the inculcation of human values becomes spontaneous. And this is true for all human beings and for all times. This is what all of us really cherish and as human beings we also have the requisite potential and wherewithal to realize it. This understanding is thus a source of great solace, great relief and great confidence to the whole human race.

The universal values are the truths of existence and are always there. It is for us to discover these through self exploration and learn to live in accordance with these in order to be happy. You will also find that these values cannot be enforced through fear or greed or false beliefs.

- The values are not to be enforced through fear (*bhaya*)
- The values are not to be enforced through greed (*pralobhana*)
- The values are not to be enforced through blind faith/ belief (*ãsthâ*)

The values are naturally acceptable as we have seen, and hence there is no need for imposition or enforcement. Only right understanding through the process of self-exploration will lead to harmony in the society or organization.

This gives a very strong base to ensure value based living among human beings. Any attempt to inculcate values through fear, greed or a false belief will not be conducive to sustainable harmony in the society or organization. Only the process of understanding through self-exploration will work in the long run.

Definitiveness of Ethical Human Conduct

What is innateness of human beings? What is our humaneness in reality?

As we identify a *neem* tree or a mango tree by its well defined specific characteristics which always remain the same; as we identify water or air or iron or a cow by their respective characteristics - their innateness, similarly let us also try to identify the innateness of a human being. So as a mango tree has a definite 'mango-ness', iron has a definite 'iron-ness', cow has a definite 'cow-ness'; similarly let us understand our humane-ness.

The right understanding gained through self-exploration also enables us to identify the definitiveness of human conduct which may also be called the ethical human conduct. It is the same for all human beings. So we are also able to understand the universality of ethical human conduct which is in consonance with the universal human values. Accordingly, all debates and confusions about what is ethical for one may not be ethical for others etc. also lose their base. Let us now understand the salient features of this definite human conduct i.e. the ethical human conduct.

As we have already explored in this book, each one of us wants to have a definite conduct but presently we may not be able to ensure that. This is because we are presently living on the basis of our pre-conditionings or assumptions which are not in consonance with the truth or the right understanding. But, this situation neither gives satisfaction to us nor to others. We do see the human beings struggling to find out what the right conduct is and in the process, exhibiting a wide variety of attributes. We also see people debating endlessly about what they consider to be ethical. But unless we have the right understanding, we are not able to identify the definitiveness of ethical human conduct. It can be understood in terms of the following: (See appendix II for more details)

1. ***Values (Mülya)***: Values are a part of our ethical conduct. They are the outcome of realization and understanding, which are always definite. As already mentioned, when I understand the reality correctly, and the underlying harmony at all levels of existence and my participation in it, I am able to perceive the universal human values as a part and parcel of this reality. My imaginations are now always in terms of the definite

participation of mine in this existence in terms of fulfilment of these universal human values.

2. ***Policy (Niti)***: Having been convinced about the values and about the inherent harmony in the existence, I am able to develop an ethical sense in all my pursuits. I always think, behave and work towards nurturing this harmony. It leads us to adopt policies conducive to human welfare – conducive to enrichment, protection and right utilization of mind, body and wealth. This is an outcome of the definiteness of my desire, thought and expectation (selection) as guided by right understanding.

3. ***Character (Charitra):*** The definiteness of my desire, thought and selection gives definiteness to my living. Definitiveness of character is the outcome of the definiteness of my behaviour and work. This can be mainly characterised in terms of the following:

   - Chastity in conjugal relationship i.e. chastity in husband-wife relationship- *(sva-nari, sva - puruṣa)*
   - Rightful production acquisition and utilization of wealth (*sva-dhana)*
   - Humane behaviour and work with kindness (*dayāpürna kārya-vyavahāra*)

This definitiveness of human conduct in terms of values, policies and character is termed as Ethics.

On this basis, we get a definite notion of ethics. We get a definite criterion to judge whether an act of human being is ethical or unethical, and a definite way to work for ethics in life and profession. We can see that the ethics in the living of an individual can be imbibed only through inculcation of values, policies and character, and this is possible through the process of ensuring right understanding through self-exploration.

At the same time, we can see that a human being with ethical human conduct coupled with requisite professional skills only can be a good professional, namely, a good engineer, a good manager, a good teacher and researcher, a good technocrat, etc.

We can further qualify the ethical human conduct on the basis of the following:

- 'Ethical conduct' implies that it is naturally acceptable to me and does not give rise to conflict within.
- 'Ethical conduct' implies that it is in consonance with the right understanding of the reality – the underlying harmony at all levels.
- 'Ethical conduct' implies that it leads to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with rest of nature.

Thus, the 'ethical conduct' is self-satisfying, people-friendly, eco-friendly and universal.

Identification of *Svatva* Leading to *Svatantratã* and *Svarãjya*

We discussed about these three terms in chapter two. We had said that we will be exploring our *Svatva*; and in the process of Self-verification and living accordingly, we will be attaining *Svatantratã* and *Svarãjya.* Having discussed the content of right understanding, we can see how we explored our *Svatva* (our natural acceptance) at different levels of our living and how the dialogue that started in us helped us getting rid of our preconceived notions, our dilemmas, contradictions and compulsions, either external or internal. Having explored our *Svatva*, we are able to live accordingly and this way, we become *Svatantra*. The more, we attain this self-organized state, we are able to live in harmony with others and also we are able to help others attain this state. This leads to our participation in *Svarãjya*. You will note that this is a natural process. It leads by itself, without any external force. The more we are in dialogue with our innateness, the more organized we become.

From here we get an important message: the effort towards ensuring orderliness in the society is possible and is sustained by ensuring orderliness in ourselves. Every mechanism to bring order in the society needs to be based on this. This is an important implication of right understanding when we go to make policies for nations and the world.

Development of Human Consciousness

As explained earlier, the journey towards right understanding in fact brings a transformation in the human being from 'animal consciousness' to 'human consciousness'. We talked about this in chapter two. Having gone through the self-exploration, we can see how it helps us to initiate the development process of our consciousness. Accordingly it affects a change in one's goals, priorities and selection criteria. In 'animal consciousness' we give all the weightage to physical facilities, to the maximization of sensory pleasures, to accumulation of wealth. Our criteria of evolution are primarily body-centric, targeted towards maximization of comforts and sensory pleasures. As indicated earlier, this propensity proves to be a misery trap for human beings causing multifarious problems within us as well as in outside world as we are experiencing now a days. As we transform to the human consciousness, we are able to base our thoughts and activities on right understanding, give relationship a higher priority than physical facilities, identifying our physical needs and ensure it through *ãvartanī ïla* production, enriching rest of the nature as well.

Implications of Value-based Living

The implications of value-based living can be studied in the following terms:

1. ***At the level of individual:*** Transition towards happiness and prosperity will take place at the individual level. The individual will slowly start getting rid of the contradictions and conflicts within, and attain a state where one is able to answer his/her questions by exploring within the self. This will help the individual get rid of the tension, frustration, depression, one-upmanship and other such situations that he/she doesn't want to be in and will facilitate definite and predictable human conduct in him/her. The feeling of *Sanyama* will enable a proper care and use of the Body. It will instill self confidence and spontaneous joyfulness in the individual. This will in turn help the individual reduce the feeling of financial insecurity caused due to ill-health.

2. ***At the level of family:*** The value-based living will facilitate peace and harmony in the family, with just and fulfilling behaviour. People will feel prosperous and the feeling to nurture others will grow in the families. This will help raise the feeling of togetherness in the families, and reduce the family feuds. The prevalent problems of families will be on the wane once human living is more based on human consciousness than animal consciousness. Such harmonious living will also help reduce the competitive and consumeristic behaviour in family celebrations like marriages, parties and other social occasions.

3. ***At the level of society:*** When relationship gets higher priority over physical facilities, fearlessness and mutual trust start emerging in the society. Differentiations on the bases of body (in terms of gender, age or race), physical facilities (in terms of wealth or posts) and beliefs (in terms of isms, sects, etc.) will be reduced. The conflicts between communities, nations, races, factions and problems like naxalism, terrorism, consumerism can be solved to a large extent without any coercion or war. The feeling of undividedness will surface in the society. Fulfilment of human goal will start getting to the fore in our plans and projects at the levels of societies and nations and a universal human order based on trustful relationships can slowly emerge.

4. ***At the level of nature:*** Human beings will be in a better position to place themselves in relation with other units in nature. The problems of pollution and resource depletion can be solved as people are able to judge their needs for physical facilities correctly and fulfill these in a recyclable manner matching with the process of nature. Better methods of farming and production (avartansheel-cyclic) will help cut down problems of greenhouse gases, ozone depletion, ecological imbalance. The population of animals and birds can be saved from extinction and forests can be replenished.

One important point to be noted here is that, to validate the above, the qualitative shift in our participation in harmony at the four levels is a significant indication. The above mentioned implications will take place and start showing in the the world outside slowly.

Summary

To conclude, we have tried to highlight the following implications of right understanding in this chapter.

1. The right understanding enables us to discover that values are a natural outcome of the right understanding. They need not be imposed through fear, greed or blind belief.
2. The definitiveness of ethical human conduct is understood in terms of definiteness of values, policies and character and it is universal.
3. Identification of the innateness of human being, *Svatva*, leads to *Svatantratã* and *Svarãjya.*
4. Right understanding helps the human being to transform from animal consciousness to human consciousness.
5. This will help show positive signs of improvement in living of human beings at the level of individual, family, society and nature.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. How does right understanding provide the basis for ethical human conduct? Give two examples.
2. What are the values in interaction of human beings with the material things? Give one example of each.
3. "Human values are universal and naturally acceptable, hence these are to be explored and realized, not be enforced" - comment.
4. What do you understand by definitiveness of ethical human conduct? Why is this definitiveness desirable?
5. What is ethical human conduct? Explain it in terms of values, policies and character.
6. You were introduced to the words *Svatva, Svatantratã* and *Svarãjya* in chapter 2. How does the self-exploration in the following chapters help you to identify *swatva* and transition to *Swatantratã* and *Swarãjya*?
7. What would be the pragmatic implications of value-based living at the four levels? Briefly explain.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Basis for the Holistic Alternative towards Universal Human Order

In the last chapter, we have seen how right understanding provides the foundation for the identification of universal human values in all the dimensions of life. It also facilitates the recognition of the definitiveness of ethical human conduct. It helps us to perceive the close correlation between universal human values and happiness and to realize that the ethical human conduct is our intrinsicness. This helps the mankind transform to living with human consciousness. In this chapter, we will see further how right understanding enables us to visualize universal human goal in a comprehensive way and also provides a holistic view of human welfare. It may be pointed out that such a vision is in stark contrast to the prevailing notion of human welfare which is primarily perceived in terms of proliferation of physical facilities.

Identification of Comprehensive Human Goal

So, an important implication of the right understanding is the visualization of comprehensive human goal which is conducive to human welfare in a holistic and sustainable manner. Presently, human welfare is primarily perceived in economic terms only. We have already seen how such a narrow objective leads to problems in various spheres of life and is not sustainable. Further, in the light of the right understanding, it is possible to visualize the pattern of 'Holistic Alternative' to cater to the comprehensive human goal, a model of human living which is people friendly and eco-friendly and therefore mutually fulfilling as well as sustainable. In this process, it will be possible to visualize an alternative set of criteria to evaluate the education, healthcare systems, technologies, production systems and the models for commercial activity and management. As we have seen in chapter nine, the comprehensive human goal consists of the following:

1. Right Understanding and freedom from contradictions at the individual level *(Samãdhãna)- In every individual*

2. Prosperity and its continuity at the level of family *(Samriddhi)- In every family*

3. Fearlessness and mutual trust (*Abhaya*)- In the society

4. Co-existence *(Sah-astitva)* - In the nature

Such a comprehensive objective will be conducive to the welfare of all *(abhyudaya)* for all times. This will apply to all the human beings on earth. We can also understand that facilitating and empowering human beings towards the fulfilment of the above mentioned comprehensive human goal is real human welfare.

Now, on this basis, we can identify the goals of any organization, system or society, either working for production, justice, exchange... etc. We can evaluate whether the goals set by the system are humane or not, whether these are comprehensive or having a limited vision. Once we are able to identify the comprehensive human goal, it becomes clear to us that in all our programs, this is going to be the primary motivation. And if any program is not subservient to these, it is not going to be fit for the society and human welfare.

In terms of these goals, we can evaluate the inadequacies in the prevalent education system, judiciary system, administration and governance, market policies and other such systems. Are we working to achieve the human goal which is naturally acceptable to us, or moving away from it? We had a brief review of our present systems in chapter nine. It revealed how our society and societal systems have deviated from human welfare. But there is no need to blame an existing system or trend. We only need to focus on the development of right understanding. We have seen that nobody accepts naturally to do wrong, we just have to provide the right direction to facilitate this.

Vision for the Holistic Alternative

A correct appraisal of the comprehensive human goal and human welfare and the realization of co-existence at all levels enable us to visualize and gradually evolve a viable alternative to the prevailing pattern of human living. Thus the right understanding prepares us for moving towards the 'holistic alternative' (universal human order, *svarājya*) which will be sustainable as well as conducive to fulfil the basic human aspirations for all human beings. It will be a mode of living which is self satisfying, people-friendly and eco-friendly. Then, all human ingenuity and creativity, all the knowledge and skills available can be harnessed to actualize such a model of living. There is an urgent need to initiate research and development in this direction as our present model of living is proving to be more and more problematic and unsustainable.

Right understanding also provides us the basis to evolve a humanistic education system, holistic health care systems, appropriate technologies, production systems and management

models, and an economic order based on recyclability and compatibility with nature. Also with the help of right understanding, it will be possible to visualize a humanistic constitution which will facilitate the development of a harmonious world family and a universal human order *(Mānavïya Vyavasthā). The* five dimensions of such a universal human order *(Mānavïya Vyavasthã)* can be worked out in detail in tune with the above mentioned objectives to usher in the holistic alternative.

Basis for Humanistic Education and Humanistic Constitution

The primary step to move towards the holistic alternative is to develop the right understanding among human beings and the commitment to live accordingly and then to develop the requisite skills and know-how to implement the right understanding in real life. In the first place, it calls for a change in the education system towards humanistic education. The right understanding provides us with the vision of such a humanistic education. As we discussed earlier, education means to imbibe the understanding of harmony at all the levels of living. It is not just reading, writing and arithmetic, but rather a process to enable the human being to live in accordance to the natural acceptance. It calls for a major shift in vision and emphasis as comparison to the existing system.

Humanistic Education

Inculcation of the right understanding at all 4 levels(from self to entire existence) and development of the competence to live in accordance with it forms the core of humanistic education. One should be able to evaluate all the endeavours in the light of right understanding. Humanistic education will incorporate appropriate integration of values and skills so that human beings are able to understand their physical needs correctly and adopt suitable techniques and production systems to cater to these needs in an eco-friendly and people friendly manner.

The humanistic education will facilitate the process of self exploration which will lead to continuous self evolution of human beings. It will also enable the realization of one's innateness *(svatva)* as well as the universality and definitiveness of ethical human conduct. It will also develop the conviction that only value based living can be conducive to continuous happiness and prosperity for one and all.

Adequate research effort is needed to evolve and implement the models of such an education. To begin with, the education of a child starts at home. The child learns and understands things living in close relations at home. So every model will entail the right kind of environment at home for the child to develop. When the child needs more exposure to skills and knowledge, he/she will need a formal system, in the form of some collective effort in the society. To start with it is necessary to introduce the required inpurts of value

education. But in the longer run, the whole education system will need to be re-designed in the light of right understanding. It is a useful exercise for us to learn how a child can be facilitated to have the right understanding since childhood, how it will learn languages, reading, writing and arithmetic skills, and skills that form a part of higher education.

Humanistic Constitution

In addition, the right understanding also provides us the basis for a humanistic constitution which is essential to provide clear guidelines and policy framework conducive to the development of an un-fragmented human society and a universal human order. Working towards the comprehensive human goal and developing the competence for ethical human conduct will be among the salient directive principles of a humanistic constitution. It will safeguard the social justice in true sense.

Presently, the human society is divided into various castes, creeds, religions and nationalities whose objectives and interests are proving contrary to those of others. Accordingly, a major part of human endeavour is used in handling these conflicts and contradictions. Paradoxically, the human beings are spending a substantial part of their energies and resources in preparing themselves for war, only to ensure peace! As we can now understand, when the parameters of human welfare are universal, i.e. commonly applicable to all human beings, why should the human endeavour in pursuit of these common objectives be conflicting to the interests of each other? This can only be there because of our ignorance, because of our incorrect assumptions/beliefs about happiness and about reality. Presently, our effort is directed towards trying to stop a wrong behaviour by means of an equally or more wrong behaviour - a crime by executing a bigger crime, a violence by greater violence. This can never be successful in the long run and only gives rise to a vicious circle to perpetuate the wrong doings. Things can only be set right by developing human consciousness, by developing right understanding and living among people and in no other way. Thus, the right understanding also offers a satisfactory and spontaneous resolution of the prevailing human conflicts ranging from the family level and going up to the global level.

Here again, it may be an educative exercise for the reader to visualize a model of humanistic constitution. In the light of the right understanding, what will the fundamental rights and duties be, what will the way be to ensure justice and protection in the society, what will the format be of working for a universal human order, how will people connect to the world family, how will the representation of people be ensured in maintaining order in the society, these all issues are to be addressed. To begin with, the family will be smallest unit of order in the society. Moving from family to the world family, the humanistic constitution will provide the basis of harmonious living. These are relevant issues in terms of visualizing the holistic alternative to the present scenario.

Universal Human Order and its Implications

So finally, it may be concluded that it is possible to move towards a universal human order with the help of suitable systems and policies evolved in the light of right understanding. Such a development will be naturally acceptable to all human beings. The whole existence except the human beings is already operating in harmony. It is for us, the human beings, to understand, to appreciate this harmony and to play our role in this total order.

On the basis of the understanding of harmony, we get the notion of an undivided society and universal human order. The universal human order will comprise of:

1. The five dimensions of human endeavour (education, heath etc.) towards a fragmented society.

2. The steps of organization from family to world family, each anchored in right understanding will integrate in the following way:

family ⇒ family cluster ⇒ village/community ⇒ village cluster ⇒⇒⇒ world family

We had listed the five dimensions in chapter nine. In each of the five dimensions, we can visualise a humane system, be it education, health, production, exchange or justice and conceptualize a harmoniously functioning society. The social organization can proceed from family to world family with representative bodies of persons endowed with the right understanding at each level.

In contrast, one can also study the functioning of nations and states today, and evaluate their working in the light of a universal human order. We definitely need to avail from the tremendous store house of know-how and skills available at present times and use these in the above mentioned humane way.

Summary

1. The right understanding helps us identify the comprehensive human goal in terms of *Samãdhãna, Samriddhi, Abhaya, Sah-astitva* and set all our sub-goals based on these.

2. This gives us the vision of the 'holistic alternative' in all the dimensions of human living.

3. The understanding of harmony gives the basis and framework of humanistic education and humanistic constitution.

4. The universal human order in terms of five dimensions of society and steps of organization from family to world family can be visualised on this basis.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What do you mean by the 'holistic alternative'? What is the vision for the holistic alternative?
2. Visualize a framework for humanistic education for children. Suggest a few ways to modify present day school education.
3. How does right understanding provide the basis for humanistic constitution? Suggest some aspects of such a constitution to promote holistic living.
4. What do you mean by Universal Human Order? What are its implications on the different dimensions of a society?
5. Choose any one dimension (education, heath, production, justice, exchange) of human endeavour in a society. Suggest what role can you play in the chosen dimension through the orientation you are going to have through your professional education.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Professional Ethics in the Light of Right Understanding

Profession is a significant domain of human activity targeted towards participating in the larger order which includes the society and nature around. Thus, it is a meaningful participation for each one in one or more of the five domains of human endeavour needed for a harmonious society. Of this, one important domain happens to be in the form of production and production related activities. It also makes available the necessary physical facilities (livelihood) for oneself and one's family. Here, one has to interact with other human beings as well as the living and non-living entities of rest of nature. Through professional education, one acquires the specific skills and knowledge in order to make this contribution in the larger order. Ethical conduct of profession implies the right utilization of one's professional skills towards the fulfilment of comprehensive human goal and thus, meaningfully participate in the larger order. Therefore, it is expected from a competent professional to carry out one's profession with right understanding, dexterity and commitment so that the effort is conducive to human welfare i.e. conducive to the happiness and prosperity of all and also to the enrichment of rest of nature. However, to be able to achieve this, it is essential to develop the value competence or the ethical competence in the human beings along with the requisite skills. Presently, there is an increasing thrust on sophistication of professional skills and most of the effort in education is directed towards this objective. There is hardly any emphasis on developing the ethical competence which is acquired through appropriate Value Education. It may be easily appreciated that a significant implication of the right understanding is to develop this ethical competence and thereby facilitate professional ethics.

The issues pertaining to the unethical conduct of profession are presently becoming a matter of widespread concern. With increase in skills and know-how and with the availability of sophisticated technologies and systems for large scale networking to harness these skills, the human beings have acquired tremendous power to influence the lives of their fellow beings as well as the state of nature on this planet. In such a situation, it becomes crucial to

ensure the ethical utilization of the professional capabilities. And such competence can only be acquired through right understanding and the orientation to live in accordance with it i.e. ethical human conduct (discussed in detail in chapter 12).

If we look at the driving ethos in the present times, it is noticed that the main thrust all around is towards the so called economic development which in practice essentially reduces to widespread tendencies towards wealth accumulation or profit maximization and proliferation of physical facilities which are imagined to be the means to achieve happiness and prosperity. As a result, all the skills, know-how, technologies and resources get harnessed in this direction only. This is creating multiple global maladies as well as contradictions and dilemmas at various levels. The globalization of this trend is already resulting in hazardous consequences. Hence, it is becoming increasingly urgent to rectify this situation and this can be done effectively only through the development of right understanding.

In this chapter, we shall first try to understand the profession in right perspective and then visualize how the real competence in professional ethics can be ensured. Further, we will also have a glance at the current scenario in regard to professional ethics – resulting in widespread proliferation of unethical practices in a variety of ways. We will also draw attention to the inadequacy of various methods being used to curb this trend. We will try to understand how the inherent dichotomy of the prevailing worldview vis-à-vis the expectation of professional ethics is generating multiple contradictions and dilemmas which can not be resolved unless there is a change in human consciousness through right understanding.

Profession – In the Light of Comprehensive Human Goal

As mentioned earlier, any profession is a channel for participation by human beings in the larger order in pursuance of comprehensive human goal. In the process, one is able to contribute towards the livelihood of one's family and also participate in the larger order constituting the society and the nature around. All these activities do require a certain degree of skill and are expected to be performed in consonance with the comprehensive human goal. Then only, these will be conducive to the sustained welfare of the individual as well as the society. The excellence or the success of any professional activity is to be judged from this comprehensive point of view only and not in terms of just wealth generation. Accordingly, the profession is not only a means of earning one's livelihood but a means of one's evolution by appropriate participation in the larger order. It is an important activity to authenticate one's understanding, whereby we interact with other human beings and with rest of nature in a mutually fulfilling manner. Thus, profession is a 'service'.

Having understood the above notion of profession, let us pause a while to investigate how we are presently looking at the profession. What is in our mind when we try to choose a professional career? What do we consider as a good profession? What is the general view of the parents in regard to an appropriate profession for their children? In what way do the people in society give value to various professions? This is very important for us to find out. The general perception in which the professions are presently looked at, is in terms of being able to earn more and more money, getting more power, getting more perks or comforts etc. Isn't it? Varify this yourself.

Such a view which is widely prevailing inherently comes in conflict with the expectations of professional ethics to ensure the sustained welfare of all. These aspects will be discussed subsequently when we will have a look at the current scenario in detail. Here, it may suffice to sum up that the real way to ensure ethical conduct of profession is to have a correct understanding of profession, a correct understanding of happiness and prosperity and then to develop the competence to fulfil this notion. The whole purpose of value education is to enable the development of this understanding and competence which is essential to ensure professional ethics.

Ensuring Competence in Professional Ethics

Having understood the profession in right perspective, let us clearly demarcate what we mean by developing ethical competence or the value competence of an individual which is the only effective way to ensure professional ethics. In absence of such a competence, administering oaths and prescribing codes of conduct etc. become mere formalities. Before proceeding further, let us also try to visualize as to why a person acts unethically. It is primarily because of lack of correct understanding about happiness and prosperity. If a person views happiness in terms of maximization of sensory enjoyment and prosperity in terms of accumulation of physical facilities, then the motivation naturally becomes that of wealth maximization. In this pursuit, all other considerations become secondary. Therefore, it leads to more and more unethical practices as these seem to cater well to the above misconceived notion of happiness. Immediate attractiveness of the outcome of such pursuits tends to make people adhere to this wrong notion firmly. As many other people seem to be following the same path and apparently 'gaining' from it, this is believed to be the only pragmatic way of living. In this context, the ethical considerations are considered to be too idealistic to follow in real life.

As already mentioned, the development of ethical competence is a long-term process to be achieved through appropriate value education. As profession is only a subset of the life activities, the competence in profession will only be the manifestation of one's right understanding.

The salient features characterizing this competence can be summarized as follows:

Competence in Professional Ethics

1. Clarity about the comprehensive human goal: *Samãdhãna-Samriddhi- Abhaya- Sah-astitva* and its fulfilment through universal human order from family to world family.
2. Confidence in oneself as well as confidence in the harmony, co-existence and self-regulation prevailing in entire existence based on the right understanding of oneself and the rest of existence.
3. Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour, clarity and confidence in ethical human conduct and its correlation with sustainable personal as well as collective happiness and prosperity.
4. Competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature, ability to assess the needs for physical facilities for the family and their fulfilment through production systems ensuring harmony in the nature.
5. Competence of actualizing one's understanding in real life.

Issues in Professional Ethics – The Current Scenario

The issues in professional ethics are becoming very complex in the current scenario. The unethical practices are rapidly increasing and their impact is also becoming far-reaching. Corruption in multifarious manifestations is afflicting all the professions like a virus. Similarly, other unethical practices are also proliferating and getting out of control. It appears as if human ingenuity is being increasingly harnessed to devise newer and subtler ways to thwart the ethical conduct of profession, to twist the laws and to beat the system. A good number of people have started nurturing the feeling that with money, everything can be accomplished, any person can be 'purchased', and any system can be bent to one's advantage. As a result of this 'epidemic' of unethical practices, we are frequently coming across serious scams, major economic offences and kickbacks in large scale purchases. These are also manifesting in the form of *hawãlã* and *benãmï* transactions, in fact, leading to a parallel black market economy. Lapses on the part of big organizations in ethical conduct of profession have led to large scale disasters, such as Bhopal Gas Tragedy, the Chernobyl Disaster, etc., endangering public life and property, and causing serious degradation to environment.

This menace becomes even more serious as unethical policies are adopted collectively by large industries, cartels, multinational corporations and even national governments. As a result, there is a sort of 'legitimization' of these unethical policies by projecting them to be in the interest of large groups of people. We also observe strong influences being exercised

by various such groups which are frequently referred to as drug-mafia, builder-mafia and arms-mafia etc. by the media. Such vested interest groups lobby together and destabilize the economies and even governments of different nations. The strong influence exerted by, say oil companies and oil-producing countries, on international politics is well-known.

We are also quite familiar how misleading propaganda, advertisements using sex-appeal, the influence of show-business and celebrities are being employed to influence the public mind for promoting all types of products which are not quite conducive to human welfare. There is no need to elaborate too much on all these forms of deteriorating professional ethics, as all of us are not only victims of this degradation, but at many occasions feel compelled to even contribute to it directly or indirectly or remain helpless onlookers. We may enlist some salient categories of these unethical practices as follows:

- Corruption in multiple forms and at various levels
- Tax evasion, misappropriation and misuse of public funds
- Misleading propaganda, unethical advertisements and sales promotion
- Cut-throat competition
- Exploiting the weakness of consumers through various enticements
- Adulteration and spurious production
- Endangering the health and safety of public at large
- Hoarding and over-charging etc.

…the list could be much longer.

Why is all this happening? Who is contributing to the aggravation of this situation? What is its impact on our happiness and prosperity? These are important points for us to ponder and explore.

In this context, it will also be educative to look at the various methods and mechanisms which are being presently employed to check these trends and their effectiveness.

It is true that the adverse impact of this malaise is being widely felt, and the concern for rectifying the situation is increasing in the society. Many agencies such as the government bodies, professional societies, NGO's, media and professional educators etc. are all trying to devise ways and means to control the situation. However, all the methods being adopted are either of symptomatic nature or punitive measures or crisis management techniques rather than real solutions to the whole problem. For example, the following methods are being increasingly proposed and implemented:

- Promoting awareness about professional ethics by introducing new courses, refresher

programs and case studies

- Administering oaths and prescribing codes of ethical conduct for specific professional disciplines
- Setting up mechanisms for intensive audit inspection and monitoring the activities
- Framing more stringent laws and devising harder punishments for offences
- Promoting transparency in working systems through mechanisms like RTI (right to information act), etc.
- Carrying out 'sting operations' and widely publicising serious lapses in ethical conduct of profession through media
- Encouraging whistle blowing by individuals or groups
- Setting up vigilance commissions, ethics committees, tribunals, consumer protection forums etc.
- Filing public interest litigations etc.

While there is no denying the fact that all the above methods are with earnest intention to tackle the present situation, however, these have a temporary utility and prove deterrent to a limited degree only. The focus in these methods is primarily towards curbing the ill-effects rather than rectifying the root cause, namely the faulty world-view, which continues to remain dominant. The real way out is to work towards developing the ethical competence by transforming the consciousness of the people through right understanding. Unless the inherent dichotomy between the wrongly perceived notion of happiness through wealth maximization and the expectations of human welfare, the expectations of common good is resolved, no breakthrough is possible.

Inherent Contradictions and Dilemmas and their Resolution

We can understand more clearly through examples how the contradictions and dilemmas are inherently generated by the prevailing worldview in which wealth maximization is perceived to be the prime objective. In such a paradigm, 'your loss is my gain'. Thus the other person's happiness seems to be in conflict with my happiness. In that case, the other people have to be exploited for one to gain affluence and there is no possibility of mutual fulfilment in a sustainable way. In the same way, exploitation of nature also becomes acceptable as it helps a person to accumulate wealth easily and there is no limit to this.

Let us analyse how such a world view affects the propensity of people in different professions. Take the example of business circles, whenever there is a scarcity of commodity due to say –

monsoon failure or other natural disturbances or wars etc, the people in general are in distress and need succour; however in such a situation the businessmen endowed with materialistic world view will feel elated and look at it as an opportunity to make maximum profit. They feel that the market is 'improving' and they should take the maximum advantage of it, even accentuate it by hoarding and black marketing to serve their objective. Thus the interest of such businessmen and the consumers in general come in direct conflict. While in reality they are expected to be mutually complementary. In a similar way, unethical practices like adulteration and spurious production etc. are also adopted in an attempt to increase profits-*albeit* at the cost of greatly endagering public health and safety.

An interesting example of the prevailing dichotomy is evident in the advertisements that we daily come across, particularly in case of various evidently harmful products like cigarettes, *pan masala* etc. Where on one hand, the use of these products is highly glamorized to attract the consumers and in the end there is an inconspicuous statutory warning indicating that the use of these products is injurious to health. Thus there is clear tendency of making profits by promoting the sale of the products which are injurious to public health. In such a situation the dilemma as to how much importance is to be given to one's profit and how much to the welfare always remains unresolved.

Similarly, let us highlight the dilemma in any profession which arises when the prime motivation is towards profit maximization. Take the example of practising medicos with the urge of profit maximization. Supposing there is an epidemic and a large number of people become sick, the doctors endowed with materialistic world view will feel excited as it would give them an opportunity to earn a lot of money. Thus, the degradation in the health of society becomes a welcome opportunity for those whose expected role in the society is to facilitate the health of people. Here again the dilemma always persists whether to give importance to one's profit or to the welfare of people needing help. Driven by the profit mania one can adopt methods of extreme exploitation of the patients who are already in serious trouble.

We can make similar visualizations for each profession whereby the motivations of profit maximization eventually lead to unethical practices of various dimensions and thwart the very objective of these professions in contributing towards the common good, towards the larger order. With all this, a continuous contradiction persists in the mind of such people as these unethical processes are not naturally acceptable to anyone. They create tension and anxiety at the personal level and one is tempted to adopt dual personality in terms of trying to appear to be ethical and in reality acting differently. There is a need to hit the nail on the head. The resolution of all these contradictions and dilemmas can only come through right understanding. Thus, the crux of all this discussion is that sincere effort towards building up the ethical competence of human beings in general and professionals in particular through proper value education is the only effective way to safeguard professional ethics.

Summary

1. Profession implies meaningful participation in the larger order including society and nature in pursuance of comprehensive human goal and in the process also making available the necessary physical facilities for one's family.

2. Developing ethical competence in the individuals (professionals) is the only effective way to ensure professional ethics.

3. The competence in professional ethics manifest as follows:

   a. Clarity about the comprehensive human goal: *Samadhan-Samriddhi- Abhay- Sah-astitva*.

   b. Confidence in oneself as well as confidence in the harmony and co-existence prevailing in entire existence based on the right understanding of oneself and the rest of existence

   c. Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour, clarity and confidence in ethical human conduct and its correlation with sustainable personal as well as collective happiness and prosperity.

   d. Competence of mutually enriching interaction with Nature, ability to assess the needs for physical facilities for the family and their fulfilment through production systems ensuring harmony in the nature.

   e. Competence of actualizing one's understanding.

4. The increase of unethical practices in various professions, the contradictions and dilemmas are primarily due to the prevailing worldview focussing on profit maximization. These can only be resolved through right understanding.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What do you mean by 'profession'? Why is it required to acquire ethical competence in profession?
2. What do you understand by competence in professional ethics? Elaborate.
3. Critically examine the issues in professional ethics in the current scenario. List any five unethical practices in profession today and the methods being tried to curb them. Comment on the long term effectiveness of these methods.
4. What are the inherent contradictions and dilemmas of professional ethics in the prevailing world view? How does right understanding resolve these issues?
5. Imagine that you have joined at middle management level in an organization where you find unethical practices prevalent. How will you proceed to promote ethics among your colleagues? Mention a few steps you may take to improve the situation without creating an atmosphere of opposition.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Vision for Holistic Technologies, Production Systems and Management Models

As discussed in Chapter-13, the right understanding provides us the vision for a holistic alternative. It provides the vision for *mānaviya vyavasthā* – a model of living which is inherently conducive to the needs of all human beings and also compatible with nature; a model which is conducive to the development of harmonious human society at a global level; a model which paves way for a sustainable, universal human order leading to happiness, peace and prosperity. Of course, such a model will necessitate the visualization and development of appropriate technologies, production systems and management models which cater to the comprehensive human goal of '*samādhāna, smriddhi, abhaya* and *sah-astitva*'. It will be necessary to develop and popularize technologies and systems conducive to human welfare – to *abhyudaya* or *sarvodaya* and not merely focus attention on economic growth.

The development of such systems and devices requires right understanding and a close scrutiny of the systems and processes of nature, as these are all basically holistic, time tested and self regulated. Of course, there is an ample scope for creative processing on the part of human beings to make them more conducive to human use. Further, it will also require a careful learning from some of the traditional practices, critically examining them so that we are able to identify their strengths and desirable features and retain them while evolving technologies and systems for our present needs. Only then we can appropriately harness the store house of traditional wisdom along with the present day knowledge of science and technology. In this chapter, we will try to identify the salient criteria for assessing and developing appropriate technologies, production systems and management models. Thereafter a glimpse of such systems will also be presented through typical examples.

The Holistic Criteria for Evaluation

The modern technologies and systems are all human inventions in response to the needs visualized under the influence of the prevailing worldview. Accordingly, they have been designed and optimized to the objective functions best suited to this world view. In order to facilitate the development of holistic technologies and systems, it will be necessary to visualize alternative objective functions and to formulate appropriate criteria for evaluation compatible with comprehensive human goal.

Generally speaking, there are three broad criteria to guide the development of such technologies and systems, viz.,

(a) Catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles,

(b) People-friendly, and

(c) Eco-friendly.

In addition, these have to promote local self-sufficiency and optimal utilization of local resources and expertise.

In accordance to the above general considerations, the specific criteria for judging the appropriateness of technologies, production systems and management models may be identified as follows:

Criteria for Technologies

The above mentioned general criteria can be itemized into more specific form as follows:

- Catering to real human needs
- Compatible with natural systems and cycles
- Facilitating effective utilization of human body, animals, plants and materials
- Safe, user-friendly and conducive to health
- Producible with local resources and expertise as far as possible
- Promoting the use of renewable energy resources
- Low cost and energy efficient
- Enhancing human interaction and cooperation

- Promoting decentralisation
- Durability and life cycle recyclability of products

For Production Systems

In determining the type of production systems, the key questions to be answered are:

- What to produce?
- How to produce?
- For whom to produce?
- And how much to produce?

All these will be decided in the context of availability of local natural resources and the needs of the people for any given community. Of course, the needs are to be characterised in consonance with the comprehensive human goal. The specific criteria to judge the appropriateness of the production systems may include the following:

- Optimal utilization of local resources and expertise
- Economic viability and sustainability
- Priority for local consumption
- Matching the pattern of production with the availability/ producibility in the local environment and the pattern of consumption
- Decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment of people in the community
- Facilitating production by masses and not mass production in a centralized mode
- Promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment
- Using people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies
- Ensuring requisite quality of production
- Safe and conducive to the health of persons involved in production as well as others

For Management Models

The management needs to focus at the fulfilment of the people involved in the production system as well the users of the produce and not to profit-mania. The following criteria can be chosen for a humanistic management model:

- The whole unit working as a well-knit family
- Cooperative and motivational
- Ensuring correct appraisal of human labour
- Targeting employer-employee as well as consumer satisfaction and not profit maximisation
- Sharing of responsibility and participative mode of management
- Continuous value addition of the persons involved
- Effectively integrating individual competencies and complementarity

A Critical Appraisal of the Prevailing Systems

It will be educative to critically examine the characteristics of the present models which have been developed under the influence of the materialistic worldview. It is important to point out that the structure as well as the use of all human innovations is strongly influenced by the worldview and values. Therefore, the present day technologies and systems are designs best suited to serve the prevailing worldview. This way, we can easily appreciate how the present day systems, even though they employ the best of human ingenuity, latest scientific knowledge and sophisticated technologies, are largely proving to be incompatible with ecology and also not conducive to sustainable human welfare.

The most concerning feature of the present day systems is their heavy dependence on non-renewable sources of energy/materials rendering them unsustainable. The modern development primarily dwells upon fossil fuels which are being consumed at exponential rates. This has caused menace of resource depletion on one hand and environmental degradation manifesting in the form of pollution and global warming etc. on the other. There is no compatibility with the rate of consumption and the rate of production in Nature. The other undesirable characteristics of modern technologies and systems include their centralized configurations, promotion of wastefulness, excessive transporation and substitution of human, animal and other natural resources.

These systems are becoming more and more complex and large in size, and they are highly capital and energy intensive. Increased automation and mechanization is being used for promoting mass production which is not conducive to large scale employment of people. Such systems also lead to exploitation, alienation and conflict between the so-called working class and management. Inspite of a high degree of sophistication, quality consciousness, standardization, miniaturization and user-friendliness, these technologies and systems are not proving conducive to general human welfare. It is an irony that with all the technological

advances, we have come to a passé where the whole planet is under a serious threat.

Learning from the Systems in Nature and Traditional Practices

If we really wish to gain an insight into the holistic systems, we have a lot to learn from systems of nature and from traditional practices. With modern developments in science and technology, and their widespread application, an impression has grown that the nature is primarily for exploitation as per the whims and fancies of human beings, the nature has to be tamed/controlled and exploitated for human enjoyment. Further, it is believed that the systems in nature are all primitive and have to be replaced by man-made systems. This is how one looks at 'development'. Similarly, it is also believed that the traditional practices are all obsolete and have to be rejected outright. This arrogant attitude towards nature and the traditional know-how has caused much damage to humanity in recent times. It is high time we critically examine these beliefs and rectify them in the light of right understanding.

In reality, nature is not only our nourisher but also a learning ground. The human beings are an integral part of this self-sustaining nature and it is essential to understand its functioning and systems to live in harmony with it. After all, it is only by diligent study of nature that all the laws and principles governing various processes have been discovered by human beings. In a similar way, the systems and cycles of nature also need to be understood and emulated as required in man-made designs. Then only, we can correctly visualize and evolve the holistic way of living.

As for the traditional practices, it is true that with increase in knowledge and skills, and with changing needs, it is necessary to make improvisations in technologies and systems of human use, however, in order to do that it is essential to critically evaluate their strengths and weaknesses. It is important to identify the characteristics which have enabled the traditional practices to serve humanity for long periods. The eco-friendly and people-friendly characteristics of many traditional practices are very much worthy of our recognition and retention. Then we will be in a better position to utilize our present day knowledge to augment the systems and make them more effective, efficient and more suited to current needs. For example, we can learn a lot from the traditional practices of eco-friendly agriculture techniques, watershed management, eco-restoration, herbal formulations, preservation techniques, artisanal practices and so on. It does not amount to going backwards but rather enables us to avail from the vast storehouse of wisdom and experience so that we become better prepared to take the leap forward in the right direction.

Holistic Technologies and Systems – Typical Case Studies

Visualizing a Holistic Model of Living in Harmony at All the Levels

In the light of understanding gained so far, it will be a very educative exercise for us to visualize broadly how a typical community, say, of one thousand people will live in a holistic way in harmony with each other and the rest of nature, being largely self-sufficient in fulfilment of its needs and setting up systems which are conducive to comprehensive human goal. It may be easily appreciated that such a planning in detail is a project worthy of serious research and experimentation to evolve a viable alternative model. We may call this as a model for *Grãma-svarajya*. About hundred years ago, a vision of self-sufficient village republic was presented by Gandhiji in his famous book *Hind Swarajya*. It is high time we start working for actualization of the model of *Grãma-svarajya* in the light of right understanding. We may carry out a techno-economic feasibility study and the design for such a model keeping the comprehensive human goal as our objective function. Since it will be necessary in this model to rely on the local resources as far as possible, such a model will also need attention to augment these resources as well which includes promotion of bio-diversity, cattle, water harvesting, effective utilization of biomass, solar, wind and hydel energy sources etc. This would also involve careful planning of the agriculture, artisanal and agro-industrial activity. The matching of resources and needs will also need to be accomplished This visualization will enable us to identify, select or develop appropriate technologies, production systems and the methods to organize these activities in a harmonious way. It is left to the reader to exercise his/her creativity and try to broadly visualize the scenarios for making *Grãma-svarajya* possible. Several groups of people have started working in this direction seriously. And as a result, many technologies and systems have been evolved even though the full scale demonstration of such alternative ways of living are yet to emerge.

In the face of the environmental and other problems aggravating because of the wide-spread use of fossil fuels and other non-renewable resources, there is an increasing interest throughout the world to evolve alternative renewable technologies and modes of production. However, this is only possible in the light of right understanding, with adoption of appropriate life-styles and with proper assessment of needs. It will be desirable to get acquainted with these developments by conducting case studies on the salient renewable and eco-friendly technologies and systems. There needs to be an increasing and wide spread thrust to evolve holistic technologies and systems through dedicated R&D efforts working within the framework of right understanding. Some salient topics for case studies are given below:

Topics for Case Studies

- **Renewable and Decentralized Energy Technologies**

  (a) Biomass based Energy Conversion systems such as;

  - Systems for generation and utilization of Biogas obtainable from anaerobic digestion of all kinds of moist biomass such as animal and human excreta, kitchen waste, moist agro-waste, sewage effluents etc. This bio-conversion also results in production of valuable bio-manure in the form of slurry. Therefore, a study of slurry handling systems is also relevant.
  - Systems for generation and utilization of Producer gas obtainable from partial combustion of all kinds of dry biomass such as wood, charcoal, rice-husk, sawdust, dry agro-waste etc.
  - Systems for decentralized production of Biodiesel obtainable from esterification of various vegetable oils.
  - Decentralized systems for production of ethanol as a liquid fuel for engines obtainable form agro-waste
  - Technologies for Briquetting to obtain a compact/smokeless solid fuel from all kinds of loose biomass.
  - Technologies for smokeless and energy efficient cook stoves

  (b) Gadgets and Implements to facilitate efficient utilization of Human muscle power and Animal draught power such as:

  - Human operated agricultural tools and domestic appliances
  - Animal (bullock) operated irrigation pumps, tractors and other agricultural equipments
  - Improvised designs of animal driven carts

  (c) Devices for efficient utilization of Solar energy such as:

  - Solar water heaters, solar cookers, solar driers etc.
  - Solar Photo-voltaic systems
  - Decentralized Solar power generation and refrigeration systems

  (d) Decentralized Wind power devices for water pumping, electricity generation etc.

(e) Microhydel electro-mechanical power generation systems utilizing the hydro-energy of waterfalls, check-dams and flowing water in streams and rivers in a decentralized manner.

- **Systems for water conservation and water shed management for efficient utilization of rain water and for eco-restoration.**
- **Technologies and architecture promoting green building materials and energy conservation such as:**
  - Construction with compressed/stabilized mud-blocks and terracotta tiles
  - Bamboo architecture
  - Lawry-Baker low-cost brick work construction etc.
  - Solar architecture with energy conservation and passive heating/cooling of buildings
- **Organic/natural farming techniques including technologies for vermi-composting, production of bio-manures and bio-pesticides**
- **Eco-sanitation techniques for small scale decentralized sewage disposal and waste water recycling**
- **Low cost and energy efficient technologies for small scale production systems such as**
  - Systems for food processing
  - Systems for production of herbal, forest-based and animal-based *(panchgavya)* products
  - Systems for facilitating multiple crafts and artisanal work
- **Humanistic organizational/management models**

The work on the above technologies and systems is being carried out in several technical institutions, agricultural universities, government agencies and a large number of NGO's and socio-spiritual organizations as well as by some motivated individuals. It will be quite fruitful to familiarize with some of these through the above case studies.

Summary

1. The holistic criteria of evaluation basically emerge from correct appraisal of the comprehensive human goal.

2. The main guidelines are;

   (a) The capacity to cater to appropriate needs and lifestyles.

   (b) People-friendliness and eco-friendliness.

   (c) Effective utilization of local resources, local expertise and manpower and priority for local consumption.

   (d) Decentralized structure.

3. Most of the prevailing systems are human innovations in consonance with the prevailing world view. Hence, inspite of utilization of the advanced knowledge of science and technology, these are not quite conducive to sustainable human welfare.

4. A careful study and evaluation of the systems of nature and the holistic traditional practices will be helpful in the development of suitable systems as per the current needs.

5. Understanding the status and characteristics of various renewable and eco-friendly technologies and systems being developed in recent times through case studies will be helpful in motivating R&D effort in this direction.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What is the vision for *Mānaviya Vyawasthā?* Explain.
2. What are the broad holistic criteria for evaluation of technologies, production systems and management models? How do they map with the comprehensive human goal?
3. List some of the specific criteria for holistic evaluation of technologies. Elaborate on any two of them.
4. Mention some of the specific criteria to judge the appropriateness of production systems. Critically examine the present day systems on any two criteria.
5. What do you mean by holistic management model? List down a few specific characteristics of such a model.
6. In what way, is the learning from the systems of nature and traditional practices useful in the development of holistic systems?

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

Journey towards the Holistic Alternative – The Road Ahead

We are now approaching the end of this course which was intended to orient you towards right understanding and its implications in life and profession. At this concluding stage, it is appropriate to recapitulate how clearly you have been able to grasp the core message of this course and its relevance in day-to-day life. Also, it is important to ascertain whether the whole discussion has only been an academic exercise which may have been interesting but cannot be of much practical use unless, we can identify some tangible steps to move in the cherished direction. Hence, in this concluding chapter let us briefly recapitulate the core message of this course and then visualize the steps that each one of us can take for transition from our present state towards a holistic way of life.

The core message of this course may be summarized as follows:

To be able to fulfil the basic human aspirations viz. happiness and prosperity in continuity, it is essential to gain the right understanding – the understanding about oneself vis-a-vis the rest of existence, the understanding about human conduct and how it ensures continuous happiness and prosperity. This involves the realization that there is an innate harmony at all levels of existence. In fact, the whole existence is co-existence. It is the purpose of human beings to understand this harmony and co-existence and learn to live in accordance with it and be fulfilled. This truth has been grossly ignored in our present worldview whereby happiness and prosperity are perceived primarily in terms of maximization of sensory enjoyments, maximization of wealth and accumulation of more and more physical facilities. This misperception is leading to serious problems in all walks of life and is not conducive to sustainable happiness and prosperity. Hence, it becomes imperative to change this worldview, to change from 'animal consciousness' to 'human consciousness'. Guided by the right understanding, the values in relationships can also be properly understood and fulfilled. Also, in the light of right understanding, the life-styles can be appropriately designed and the need for physical facilities can be properly assessed. Further, guided by the right understanding, suitable methods of production can be adopted to fulfil these needs in a

people-friendly and eco-friendly manner. Appropriate Value Education inputs are essential to initiate this transformation towards human consciousness at a mass scale.

In this course, a preliminary outline of the framework of right understanding has been presented. An attempt has also been made to initiate the process of self-exploration to move towards right understanding.

Having obtained a brief exposure to the universal basis of values and ethical human conduct and its implications in life and profession, let us now conclude this course by indicating a few practical steps that we may take to begin this important journey towards the holistic alternative.

Appreciating the Need for Self-Exploration

The first and foremost step to begin this journey is to be adequately convinced about the need for carrying out self-exploration. The need for seriously analyzing 'what we presently are' and 'what we really want to be', the need to verify our beliefs and pre-conditionings, the need to understand what is motivating our actions presently and what its consequences are – has to be duly appreciated so that we may be able to put in the required effort and give due priority to make the transition possible.

When, through self-exploration we are able to see a big chasm between what we really want and what we are presently pursuing, then the urgency of taking the corrective steps becomes clear. Getting ready for self-exploration is, thus, the first vital step towards transition to the holistic way of life. Today, we are mostly motivated by what other people around us seem to be doing and by the attractive consequences of such actions in the immediate future. Whatever seems to be pleasant to our sensory experience appeals to us as worth pursuing. Thus, in spite of increasing problems all around we do not get motivated enough to seek a viable alternative because of our strong pre-conditioning and sensory attractions. In fact, we tend to find superficial justifications to defend our present worldview and thereby carry on with the status-quo. The whole orientation towards right understanding has been grossly missing from our present education system. Thus, the appreciation of the need for right understanding is the first trigger to transition.

Facilitating the Understanding of Harmony at Various Levels

Having realized the need adequately, the next important step is to have access to the ways and means to facilitate the process of self-exploration towards right understanding. This implies that we need to have a proper framework of understanding so that we can discover

the harmony at various levels starting from our own-self and spanning up to the entire nature/existence as discussed in this course. So, in order to facilitate this journey, it is important to make available appropriate methodology and the necessary wherewithal for Value Education which can effectively enable the process of transformation. Appropriate inputs in Value Education need to be made an integral part of all our education– both formal as well as informal. This needs a large scale effort to develop a rational and universally acceptable methodology for value education, preparation of appropriate resource material and adequate orientation of teachers to carry out this task effectively and at a large scale. Giving due priority to value education will be essential to make available the required space for this essential input in the present curricula and also devoting sufficient effort and resources to implement it successfully. The present foundation course is a step in this direction. In fact, the whole education pattern will eventually need to be revamped in the light of right understanding with due emphasis on self-exploration, value inculcation and right living *(Śikshā - Sanskāra)*. Accordingly, all the disciplines of study will have to be redesigned in the light of right understanding. The efficacy of value education will be judged on the basis of the transformation achieved in the ethos, i.e. on the basis on the clarity gained in discovering the harmony and co-existence at various levels and the competence to live in accordance with this understanding in our day-to-day life. This change of ethos among human beings will be the real harbinger of transition towards the holistic way of life leading to happiness and prosperity in a sustainable way and therefore all efforts need to be focused towards this objective.

Steps for Evolution at the Individual Level

The change of ethos involves a long drawn effort for evolution at a personal level among human beings. This begins with an exposure to the framework of right understanding as provided in this course to facilitate the process of self-exploration. Going through such a course once provides only an introductory outline, at best, a broad framework and perhaps a conviction that it is worthwhile to seek the holistic alternative seriously. A number of iterations and recapitulations through careful self-study, self-analysis, contemplation on the key proposals and guidance from competent persons will be necessary to get a clear grasp of the domain of right understanding. In this process, it will be necessary and beneficial to interact with persons who have consolidated this understanding and are sincerely trying to implement it in their day-to-day life. This has to be carried out with perseverance and commitment till we ourselves become confident to carry out the process of self-exploration and self-evolution in all our endeavours. It is also helpful to have a networking and close interaction with other people who are also convinced about this need and are trying to make efforts in this direction. Such networking will definitely expedite the individual efforts to implement the right understanding.

The framework presented in this course with the help of systematically presented proposals will help us self-evolve through the process of continuous self-observation and self-exploration. It will also facilitate the correct evaluation of our present beliefs and pre-conditionings. By focussing attention more frequently on the activities of the self and the body, it will be possible for us to clearly observe the distinction between these and correctly correlate our happiness to our natural acceptance. In the process, we will gradually move to make our behaviour more mutually fulfilling and our work with rest of nature more mutually enriching. In other words we shall move towards being more people-friendly and eco-friendly. Realizing the needs of the 'self' correctly and attempting to be in tune with the co-existence at various levels we shall also be more in harmony within, more confident of ourselves. So we understand that the major thrust of the effort towards transition is through personal evolution only, anchoring ourselves firmly and clearly in the right understanding and translating this understanding in thought, behaviour and work. The outcome of this effort will of course be highly rewarding with affirmation resulting from our own realization, our own experiential validation. Simultaneously, it will also be fulfilling to others. Once such a breakthrough is achieved, we become our own guide, we become *svatantra* – the rest will follow rather spontaneously. Once a critical mass of human beings goes through such a transformation, it will become a self-sustaining process in the society. The results of such efforts made so far with various spectra of people in the society have been very encouraging.

Steps for Transition at the Level of Family, Society and Profession

We can now appreciate that there is a strong interconnectedness and co-existence among human beings as well as in human being and rest of nature. The efforts towards self-evolution by the individuals will always be through appropriate interaction at the level of family, society and nature at large. In the paradigm of right understanding, there is an essential complementarity among all the entities including the human beings. So the steps for personal evolution are not in alienation but in proper collaboration with family, society and nature. In fact, the extent of mutual fufilment in such interactions will be an evidence of the maturity of one's understanding. Mutual fulfilment is the guiding principle which finally ensures personal happiness as well as collective happiness and harmonious co-existence with nature. So it will be an integral part of one's evolutionary effort to participate in the larger order. The participation in this respect on the part of individuals will follow the following sequence:

1. ***Right Understanding (Samajhadãri)***- Effort to gain right understanding.
2. ***Honesty (Ïmãnadãri)***- Sincerity to acknowledge what one has understood and be ready to work for complete understanding. This is followed by spontaneous reflection in one's thought, behaviour and work.

3. ***Accountability (Jimmedārï)***- Feeling one's responsibility to participate in the larger order in the light of right understanding.

4. ***Participation (Bhāgïdārï)***- Effort to actually participate in the larger order including the family, the society and the nature around according to one's competence, capacity and aptitude.

This will generate the process of mutual complementarity towards evolution of all – '*sarvodaya.'* The person with better understanding and/or physical facilities will be keen to facilitate others as this is the proof of one's own level of evolution and understanding. This is how a person having obtained right understanding will become a nucleus of change for the family and people around, a spontaneous promoter of the revolution of the right understanding. And this effort is not seen as an obligation or a sacrifice but only as a means of one's evolution. Such a transition will be comforting for everyone. It will also be helpful in dissolving the contradictions and dilemmas which arise only out of ignorance. The real effort required is only in the process of getting rid of one's false pre-conditionings in the light of the truth of Existence. The families will provide the natural training grounds for the evolution of its members, so will be a society. Such individuals and families will then be instrumental in collectively working towards *svarājya* – working towards *akhanda samāja* and *sārvabhauma vyavasthā* . The ethos in the society will gradually change from the present untenable sensuality-mania (*Kāma-unmāda*), consumerism-mania (*bhoga-unmāda*) and the profit-mania (*lābha-unmāda*) to that of working for comprehensive human goal-'*samādhāna*, *samriddhi*, *abhaya* and *sah-astitva*'. This is what is conveyed by the concept of *Saha-astitvavāda.*

Major transition steps at the level of society will consist of the following

(a) Promoting Mass Awareness and Moving towards Humanistic Education

(b) Evolving Holistic Models of Living

(c) Amending Policies, Programs and Social Systems in tune with Comprehensive Human Goal

These steps are elaborated below:

Promoting Mass Awareness and Moving towards Humanistic Education

As already mentioned, the most crucial step to affect transition in the society is by way of creating mass awareness and motivating people for self-exploration, drawing attention towards 'what we really want' and what we are presently embarking on and the consequences thereof. This awareness can be through personal interaction, through popular literature, through

formal course inputs, through workshops and seminars and utilizing the powerful network of media. This has to be followed by wide spread introduction of value education at appropriate levels including schools, colleges, professional institutions etc. In the longer run, it will be necessary to revamp the education system towards humanistic education to enable the coming generation to move towards the holistic alternative. A serious effort to carry out research, experimentation and planning to facilitate this development is essential.

Evolving Holistic Models of Living

Another important step for bringing about the requisite transition is to provide adequate thrust for carrying out R&D towards evolving holistic models of living which include development of holistic technologies, production systems and management models to actualize the holistic way of life. Presently, the trend in our institutions and research laboratories is largerly towards working on various fashionable research areas advocated by those who have pioneered the modern development and whom we have accepted as our 'role model'. However, after being amply clear that the present model and the present worldview are not sustainable and not conducive to comprehensive human goal, it will be essential to work out new models in the light of right understanding. Once the need is appropriately identified, there is no reason why, with all the human ingenuity and creativity and the vast storehouse of knowledge and available infrastructure, appropriate models cannot be developed.

Amending Policies, Programs and Social Systems in Tune with Comprehensive Human Goal

Presently, all our policies, programs, technologies and professions, as well as the economic, political and social systems have evolved to best cater to the prevailing worldview – which is seriously in error. Therefore, all these will need to be gradualy modified to suit the holistic worldview, to suit right understanding and comprehensive human goal. This may be a gradual process and will depend on the extent to which the society is able to imbibe the new ethos.

Is the Transition too Difficult?

Many a time, when the vision for the holistic alternative is discussed, apprehensions are expressed that since the ongoing trends are quite in a different direction throughout the globe, will it at all be possible to bring about the proposed changes which may appear to be idealistic! This is a point for serious exploration for all of us. We only wish to point out that

human beings have accomplished what they thought was right for them. Now, if we become clear that our worldview had been in error, nothing prevents us from understanding and adopting a worldview which is more compatible with reality and work out our way of living in consonance with it. It may be pointed out that as the consequences of the prevailaing world view are becoming more and more distressing and unaffordable, the movement towards the holistic alternative is becoming imminent. It has been amply demonstrated through the experiements conducted so far that even small steps towards right understanding are very soothing, mututally fulfilling and confidence/giving and therefore these will be welcome by individuals.

Concluding Remarks

To conclude, let us see whether we are sufficiently clear about the following proposal:

To ensure happiness and prosperity and their continuity to all human beings, the transition to human consciousness is essential. This requires a dedicated effort to implement at a mass scale, the humanistic education focusing on right understanding. It can be initiated by introduction of appropriate value education inputs in the present curricula. The urgency of this task has to be adequately realized and accordingly efforts are to be made commensurate with the need. The evolution at the personal level has to be given priority. Further, efforts are also to be directed towards evolving the new models for the holistic alternative and appropriate policies, programs and systems. Let us join hands to make the cherished transition possible!

Summary

1. Adequate realization of the need for self-exploration is the first necessary step towards transition.

2. Development of effective methodologies to facilitate self-exploration among individuals is the next essential step.

3. Major work needs to be accomplished towards evolution at the personal level, getting rid of our false pre-conditionings and clearly grasping the right understanding, identifying the harmony at various levels and actualizing such an understanding in real life.

4. The meaningful participation in the larger order is the practical way to facilitate our evolution.

5. To expedite transition towards holistic alternative, it will be necessary to create mass awareness and facilitate wide spread humanistic education. Further, extensive research thrust has to be put to evolve and implement holistic technologies and systems.

Accordingly, it will also be necessary to make appropriate amendments in the policies, programs and social systems to facilitate the transition.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What have been your achievements through this course? List the achievements in your thought, behaviour and work.
2. What are the steps for evolution at the level of family, society and profession in transition to the holistic alternative? Explain.
3. Imagine you are given a chance to represent the people. What changes in policies for the public will you make to facilitate holistic living of the people in a given time-frame?
4. List some suggestions to make value education more effective in the present scenario.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX-1

Activities of the Self ('I', *Jïvana*)

The activities, powers and potential of the Self ('I', *Jïvana*) are presented below:

Śakti	***Kriyã***		***Bala***
(Power)	(Activities)		(Potential)
Gati	*Gati*	*Sthiti*	*Sthiti*
(Manifestation)	(Manifestation)	(State)	(State)
Pramãṇa	*Pramãṇikatã*	*Anubhava*	*Ãtmã*
(Authenticity)	(Authentication)	(Realization)	(Soul)
Ritambharã	*Samkalpa*	*Bodha*	*Buddhi*
(Resoluteness)	(Resolution)	(Understanding)	(Wisdom)
Ichchhã	*Chitraṇa*	*Chintana*	*Chitta*
(Desire)	(Imaging)	(Contemplating)	(Contemplation)
Vichãra	*Vïśleṣaṇa*	*Tulana*	*Vritti*
(Thought)	(Analysing)	(Discriminating)	(Cognition)
Ãśã	*Chayana*	*Ãsvãdana*	*Mana*
(Expectation)	(Selecting)	(Tasting)	(Mind)

We discussed about some of the activities of the Self in chapter six. Here we mention some more activities and powers. The above chart can be referred to *Vyavahãrvãdï. Samãjshãstra* (Ref.-2).

The *Jïvana* (Self, 'I') is continuously active. Thus, it has activities (*Kriyã*). The capacity for the activity is termed as power (*Śakti*). The state of the Self to be active is the potential (*Bala*). We understand the Potential and Power from the Activity.

The activities are of two kinds: activities of *Sthiti* (state) and activities of *Gati* (manifestation). Let us understand with an example. I eat *rasgullã*. The taste of *rasgullã* gets placed in me as *Ãswãdana*. When I want to get the same taste, I select the sweet taste that I get from *rasgullã*. This is *Chayana*. Thus *Chayana* is expression which shows as action, while *Ãswãdana* is the state. The state and manifestation go together.

Existence is co-existence. This is the subject of realization (*Anubhava*) by the Self. The same gets authenticated as *Pramãnikatã* in the Self as the activities in the Self get into order based on the realization. The potential to realize is the Soul (*Ãtmã*) and the power is the Authenticity (*Pramãna*).

On the basis of realization, the *Self* understands the innateness of units in every order of the existence. This is Understanding (*Bodha*). The same gets reflected as Resolution (*Samkalpa*). This potential is called as Wisdom (*Buddhi*) and the power is Resoluteness (*Ritambharã*).

Based on right understanding, the *Self* is able to see the natural characteristic, i.e. the participation of every unit in the larger order around it. This is Contemplating (*Chintana*). Imaging (*Chitraṇa*) is the activity to visualize what one wants to be (which essentially means

Contd...

being according to the natural characteristics i.e. *svabhāva*). The power of *Chitraṇa* is Desire and the potential for *Chintana* is Contemplation (*Chitta*).

The *Jïvana* is always active analyzing (*Vïśleṣaṇa*) and discriminating (*Tulana*). The analyzing involves splitting an image into sub-parts. Discriminating involves accepting or rejecting on the basis of the Perception (*Dṛiṣṭi*). The power to analyze is Thought (*Vichãra*) and the potential is cognition (*Vritti*).

There are six ways of perception (*Dṛiṣṭi*)- *Priya* (being pleasant to senses), *Hita* (being conducive to body), *Labha* (being profit-oriented), *Nyãya* (being just, in human-human relations), *Dharma* (fulfilling the comprehensive human goal, the innateness of human being), *Satya* (being true, as co-existence in existence).

Based on right understanding, which the *Jïvan* gets through realization, the activity of *Tulan* has the priority set as *Satya* → *Dharma* → *Nyãya* and the perceptions of *Lãbha, Hita* and *Priya* get redefined in terms of fulfillment of the comprehensive human goal. With lack of right understanding, one gives higher priority to sensations, physical conduciveness or profit and the activity of *Tulan* remains limited to *Priya, Hita* or *Lãbha.*

The activity of selecting (*Chayana*) and tasting (*Ãsvãdana*) is there in *Jïvana* at the fifth level. We have talked extensively about these two activities in earlier chapters. The power to select is Expectation (*Ãśã*) and the potential for taste is Mind (*Mana*).

Note:

1. The words in English have been chosen to best fit with the meaning of the words in Hindi.
2. The listed words can also be spelt as *Jeevan, Shakti, Kriya, Bal, Praman, Pramanikata, Anubhav, Atma, Ritambhara, Samkalp, Bodh, Ichchha, Chitran, Chintan, Vichar, Vishleshan, Tulan, Asha, Chayan, Asvadan, Man, Hit, Labh, Nyaya, Dharm* respectively by reader for simplicity.

APPENDIX-2

Ethical Human Conduct or the Humane Conduct

Humane Conduct (*Mānavïya Ãcharaṇa*) - The conduct that is naturally acceptable to human being, the conduct of a human being living with human consciousness.

There are three aspects of it-.

1. Value (*Mülya*)- The participation of a unit in the larger order- its natural characteristic or *svabhãva*.
2. Policy (*Nïti*)- The decision (plan, program, implementation, results, evauation) about the enrichment, protection and right utilization of the resources (Self, Body and Wealth- *Mana*, *Tana* and *Dhana*).
3. Character (*Charitra*)- The definiteness of behaviour and work of human being.

Value (*Mülya*)

The values of a human being can be enumerated as thirty, which are listed below:

(a) Values in the Self (*Jïvan*, 'I'): ***Jïvan Mülya***

The values in 'I' are:

1. *Sukha* (Happiness)
2. *Śānti* (Peace)
3. *Santoṣa* (Satisfaction)
4. *Ãnanda* (Bliss)

You may refer to the figure on activities in 'I' for this:

Understanding based on Realization manifests as Bliss.

Definiteness of Desire based on Understanding manifests as Satisfaction.

Definiteness of Thought based on definiteness of Desire manifests as Peace.

Definiteness of Expectation (Selecting/Tasting) based on definiteness of Thought manifests as Happiness.

(b) Values of a human being in its participation in universal human order: ***Mãnav Mülya***

When we look at the human being with regard to its participation in universal human order, the values are:

1. Perseverance (*Dhïratã*)
2. Bravery (*Vïratã*)
3. Generosity (*Udãratã*)
4. Kindness (*Dayã*)
5. Beneficence (*Kripã*)
6. Compassion (*Karuṇã*)

Contd...

Out of these, we have already studied the first three: i.e. perseverance, bravery and generosity in the chapter ten, when we looked at the natural characteristic or *svabhāva* of a human being. The next three: i.e. kindness, benevolence and compassion are also natural characteristics of the human being. These values are *naturally acceptable* to us, and we want to live with them.

Perseverance *(Dhīratā)*– Being assured that the all-encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all levels of existence, living with this commitment without any perturbation.

Bravery *(Vīratā)* — Being assured that the all-encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all levels and *I am ready to help the other to have the right understanding*. This is the commitment to help the other have the right understanding of the harmony and living at all levels of existence.

Generosity *(Udāratā)* - Being assured that the all encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all the four levels and I am ready to invest myself, my body and wealth to help the other have the right understanding.

Kindness (*Dayā*) – If a person has the ability (*pātratā*) but does not have the means (*vastu*) to fulfil his/ her needs, the participation in relation to make available the means to fulfil the needs is kindness.

Beneficence (*Kripā*) - If a person has the means to fulfil his/ her needs but does not have the ability (competence) to utilise it, the participation in relation to imbibe the ability in him/ her is beneficence.

Compassion (*Karuṇā*)- If a person neither has the ability nor has the means to fulfil his/ her needs, the participation in relation to make available the both is compassion.

(c) Values in human-human relationship***: Sthāpita* and *Śiṣṭa Mūlya***

In Human relationships, in family and in society, we had identified nine values: Trust, Respect,…….Love. These values are called *Sthāpita* (established) values. There are also nine *Shisht* (expressed) values. The expressed values are easy to understand: the established values are in ***Self or 'I'*** and manifest as expressed values in behaviour with other humans. For example: If we have the feeling of trust established in us, it gets expressed as complementariness in behaviour with others. If we have the feeling of reverence established in us, it gets expressed as us being obedient with someone we revere. If we have the feeling of affection in us, it gets expressed as commitment in the relationship. What we need to have is the established value; the expressed value is a natural outcome. In this way, we can see that there are 9 x 2 = 18 values in human relationships.

	Established-Values	**Expressed-Values**	
1	*Vīśvāsa* (Trust)	*Saujanyatā* (Complementariness)	10
2	*Sammāna* (Respect)	*Sauhardra* (Compliance)	11
3	*Sneha* (Affection)	*Niṣṭhā* (Commitment)	12
4	*Mamatā* (Care)	*Udāratā* (Generosity)	13
5	*Vātsalya* (Guidance)	*Sahajatā* (Spontaneity)	14
6	*Shraddhā* (Reverence)	*Pujyatā* (Obedience)	15
7	*Gaurava* (Glory)	*Saralatā* (Ease)	16
8	*Kritāgyatā* (Gratitude)	*Saumyatā* (Self-restraint)	17
9	*Prema* (Love)	*Ananyatā* (Unanimity)	18

Contd...

We defined the established values in chapter eight. The reader may kindly refer to the definitions given therein. The expressed values can be understood as the expression in relationship of the feelings that go with the established values.

(d) Values of human being in the interaction with the rest of nature: ***Vastu Mülya***

So far, we have seen the values in 'I', the values as a human being and the values in human relationship, with other I. We can now see the values in relation with rest of nature. The *Vastu Moolya* (physical entity- value) is the participation of the human being with the rest of nature. It is further categorised as-

1. *Upayogita mülya* (Utility Value)
2. *Kalã mülya* (Artistic value)

We talked about these values in chapter 12. Let us summarise them here:

Utility-value: The participation of a human being in ensuring the role of physical facility in nurture, protection and providing means for the body.

Artistic-value: The participation of a human being in ensuring the role of physical facility to help and preserve its utility.

If we add these values up, we can see that there are 30 values in all, for the human being. This is what is valuable to us:

- Within the self: in 'I' *(4 values)*
- As a Human being *(6 values)*
- In Human relationships, with other human beings *(18 values)*
- With Nature *(2 values)*

Policy (*Nïti*)

Policy is the manifestation of right understanding in deciding upon the enrichment, protection and right utilization of the resources. The resources are the *Mana* (Mind), *Tana* (Body) and *Dhana* (Wealth).

The policy has three parts:

1. Economic Policy (*Artha Nïti*)
2. Political Policy (*Rãjya Nïti*)
3. Policy for universal human order (*Dharma Nïti)*
   - *Artha Nïti* is the policy for enrichment of wealth.
   - *Rajya Nït* is the policy for protection of body and wealth.
   - *Dharma Nïti* is the policy for right utilization of mind, body and wealth.

Character (*Charitra*)

Humane character means living with one's own wealth (produced by work on nature), conjugality in marital relationship and kindness in behavior and work.

It comprises of the following:

- Chastity in conjugal relationship i.e. chastity in husband-wife relationship- *(sva-narï; sva - purusa)*

Contd...

- Rightful production, acquisition and utilization of wealth (*sva-dhana)*
- Kindness in behaviour and work (*dayāpūrṇa kārya-vyavahāra*)

Note:

1. The words in english have been chosen to best fit with the meaning of the words in Hindi.
2. The listed words can also be spelt as *Manaveeya Acharan, Moolya, Neeti, Sukh, Shanti, Santosh, Anand, Dheerata, Veerata, Udarata, Daya, Kripa, Karuna, Sthapit, Shisht, Vishvas, Samman, Mamata, Vatsalya, Shraddha, Gaurav, Kritagyata, Prem, Saujanyata, Sauhardra, Nishtha, Sahajata, Poojyata, Saralata, Saumyata, Ananyata, Upayogita, Kala, Man, Tan, Dhan, Arth, Rajya, Dharm Sva-nari, Sva-purush, Sva-dhan, Dayapoorna, Karya-vyavahar* respectively by reader for simplicity.

APPENDIX-3

Typical Course Syllabus

Module 1: Introduction to Value Education **No of Lectures [6]**

1. Understanding the need, basic guidelines, content and process for Value Education
2. Self-exploration – its content and process; 'Natural Acceptance' and Experiential Validation – as the mechanism for self exploration
3. Continuous Happiness and Prosperity – A look at basic human aspirations
4. Right understanding, Relationship and Physical Facilities – The basic requirements for fulfillment of aspirations of every human being
5. Understanding Happiness and Prosperity correctly – A critical appraisal of the current scenario
6. Method to fulfill the above human aspirations: Understanding and living in harmony at various levels

Module 2: Harmony in the Human Being **No of Lectures [6]**

7. Understanding human being as a co-existence of the sentient 'I' and the material 'Body'
8. Understanding the needs of Self ('I') and 'Body' - *Sukh* and *Suvidhã*
9. Understanding the Body as an instrument of 'I' (I being the doer, seer and enjoyer)
10. Understanding the characteristics and activities of 'I' and harmony in 'I'
11. Understanding the harmony of 'I' with the Body: *Sanyam* and *Svãsthya*; correct appraisal of physical needs, meaning of prosperity in detail
12. Programs to ensure *Sanyam* and *Svãsthya*

Module 3: Harmony in the Family and Society **No of Lectures [6]**

13. Understanding harmony in the Family – the basic unit of human interaction
14. Understanding values in human-human relationship; meaning of *Nyãya* and program for its fulfillment to ensure Ubhaya –tripti; Trust (*Vi̅svãsa*) and Respect (*Sammãna*) as the foundational values of relationship
15. Understanding the meaning of *Vi̅svãsa* ; Difference between intention and competence
16. Understanding the meaning of *Sammãna*, Difference between respect and differentiation; the other salient values in relationship
17. Understanding the harmony in the society (society being an extension of family): *Samãdhãna*, *Samriddhi*, *Abhaya*, *Sah-astitva* as comprehensive Human Goals
18. Visualizing a universal harmonious order in society – Undivided Society (*Akhand̅ Samãj*), Universal Order (*Sãrvabhauma Vyavasthã*)- from family to world family.

Module 4: Harmony in the Nature (Existence) **No of Lectures [4]**

19. Understanding the harmony in the Nature

Contd...

20. Interconnectedness and mutual fulfillment among the four orders of nature – recyclability and self-regulation in nature
21. Understanding existence as co-existence (*Sah-astitva*) of mutually interacting units in all-pervasive space
22. Holistic perception of harmony at all levels of existence

Module 5: Implications of the Holistic Understanding – A Look at Professional Ethics

No of Lectures [6]

23. Natural acceptance of human values
24. Definitiveness of Ethical Human Conduct
25. Basis for Humanistic Education, Humanistic Constitution and Universal Human Order
26. Competence in Professional Ethics:
    (a) Ability to utilize the professional competence for augmenting universal human order,
    (b) Ability to identify the scope and characteristics of people-friendly and eco-friendly production systems, technologies and management models
27. Case studies of typical holistic technologies, management models and production systems
28. Strategy for transition from the present state to Universal Human Order:
    (a) At the level of individual: as socially and ecologically responsible engineers, technologists and managers
    (b) At the level of society: as mutually enriching institutions and organizations

Note: After every two lectures, there will be a two-hour practice session. Typical exercises for practice sessions are given below:

EXERCISES FOR PRACTICE SESSIONS

Module 1: Introduction to Value Education

PS 1: Introduce yourself in detail. What are the goals in your life? How do you set your goals in your life? How do you differentiate between right and wrong? What have been your salient achievements and shortcomings in your life? Observe and analyze them.

Expected outcome: the students start exploring themselves; get comfortable with each other and with the teacher and start appreciating the need and relevance of the course.

PS 2: Now-a-days, there is a lot of talk about many techno-genic maladies such as energy and material resource depletion, environmental pollution, global warming, ozone depletion, deforestation, soil degradation, etc. – all these seem to be man-made problems, threatening the survival of life on Earth – What is the root cause of these maladies & what is the way out in your opinion?

On the other hand, there is rapidly growing danger because of nuclear proliferation, arms race, terrorism, criminalization of politics, large scale corruption, scams, breakdown of

Contd...

relationships, generation gap, depression & suicidal attempts etc. – what do you think, is the root cause of these threats to human happiness and peace – what could be the way out in your opinion?

Expected outcome: the students start finding that technical education without inculcation of human values can generate more problems than solutions. They also start feeling that lack of understanding of human values is the root cause of all problems and the sustained solution could emerge only through understanding of human values and value-based living.

PS 3:

1. Observe that each one of us has the faculty of 'Natural Acceptance', based on which one can verify what is right or not right for him. (As such we are not properly trained to listen to our 'Natural Acceptance' and many a time it is also clouded by our strong pre-conditionings and sensory attractions).

   Explore the following:

   (i) What is 'Naturally Acceptable' to you in relationship—the feeling of respect or disrespect for yourself and for others?

   (ii) What is 'Naturally Acceptable' to you – to nurture or to exploit others?

   Is your living in accordance with your natural acceptance or different from it?

2. Out of the three basic requirements for fulfillment of your aspirations- right understanding, relationship and physical facilities- observe how the problems in your family are related to each. Also observe how much time & effort you devote for each in your daily routine.

Expected outcome:

1. The students are able to see that verification on the basis of natural acceptance and experiential validation through living is the only way to verify what is right or wrong. Referring to any external source like a particular text or instrument or any person cannot enable them to verify with authenticity; it may only help develop assumptions.

2. The students are able to see that in many cases, their actual living is not in harmony with their natural acceptance, and the first thing they need to do is to refer to their natural acceptance, to remove this disharmony.

3. The students are able to see that lack of right understanding leading to lack of relationship, is the major cause of problems in their family and with friends - not the lack of physical facilities in most of the cases. However, most persons give higher priority to acquiring physical facilities in their life, ignoring relationships. They are so far not aware that right understanding is the most important requirement for any human being!

Module 2: Harmony in the Human Being

PS 4: List down all your important desires. Observe whether the desire is related to Self ('I') or the Body. If it appears to be related to both, visualize which part of it is related to Self ('I') and which part is related to Body.

Expected outcome: the students are able to see that they can enlist their desires and the desires are not vague. Also they are able to relate their desires to 'I' and 'Body' distinctly. If any desire appears related to both, they are able to see that the feeling is related to 'I' while the physical facility is related to the body. They are also able to see that 'I' and 'Body' are two distinct realities, and a large part of their desires are related to 'I' and not the body, while their

Contd...

efforts are mostly centered on the fulfillment of the needs pertaining to the body, in the hope that it will meet the needs of 'I' too.

PS 5:

1. a. Observe that any physical facility you use, follows the given sequence with time:

   Necessary and tasteful → unnecessary but still tasteful → unnecessary and tasteless → intolerable

   b. In contrast, observe that any feeling in you is either naturally acceptable or not acceptable at all. If naturally acceptable, you want it continuously and if not acceptable, you do not want it any moment!

2. List down all your important activities. Observe whether the activity is of 'I' or of Body or with the participation of both 'I' and Body.

3. Observe the activities within 'I'. Identify the object of your attention for different moments (over a period of say 5 to 10 minutes) and draw a line diagram connecting these points. Try to observe the link between any two nodes.

Expected outcome:

1. The students are able to see that all physical facilities they use are required for a limited time in a limited quantity. Also they are able to see that in case of feelings, they want continuity of the naturally acceptable feelings and they do not want feelings which are not naturally acceptable even for a single moment.

2. The students are able to see that activities like understanding, desire, thought and selection are the activities of 'I' only, the activities like breathing, palpitation, blood circulation etc. are fully the activities of the body with the acceptance of 'I' while the activities they do with their sense organs like hearing through ears, seeing through eyes, sensing through touch, tasting through tongue and smelling through nose or the activities they do with their work organs like hands, legs etc. are such activities that require the participation of both 'I' and body.

3. The students become aware of the activities of 'I' and start finding their focus of attention at different moments. Also they are able to see that many of their desires are coming from outside (through preconditioning or sensations) and are not based on their natural acceptance.

PS 6:

1. Chalk out some programs towards ensuring your harmony with the body - in terms of nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the body.

2. Find out the plants and shrubs growing in and around your campus, which can be useful in curing common diseases.

Expected outcome: The students are able to list down activities related to proper upkeep of the body and practice them in their daily routine. They are also able to appreciate the plants wildly growing in and around the campus which can be beneficial in curing different diseases.

Module 3: Harmony in the Family and Society

PS 7: Form small groups in the class and make them carry out a dialogue focusing on the following eight questions related to 'TRUST';

1a. Do I want to make myself happy?

Contd...

2a. Do I want to make the other happy?

3a. Does the other want to make himself/herself happy?

4a. Does the other want to make me happy?

What is the answer?

Intention (Natural Acceptance)

1b. Am I able to always make myself happy?

2b. Am I able to always make the other happy?

3b. Is the other able to always make himself/herself happy?

4b. Is the other able to always make me happy?

What is the answer?

Competence

Let each student answer the questions for himself and everyone else. Discuss the difference between intention and competence. Observe whether you evaluate yourself and others on the basis of intention/ competence.

Expected outcome: The students are able to see that the first four questions are related to our Natural Acceptance i.e. Intention and the next four to our Competence. They are able to note that the intention is always correct, only competence is lacking! We generally evaluate ourselves on the basis of our intention and others on the basis of their competence! We seldom look at our competence and others' intention as a result we conclude that I am a good person and other is a bad person!

PS 8:

1. Observe, on how many occasions, you are able to respect your related ones (by doing the right evaluation) and on how many occasions you are disrespecting by way of under-evaluation, over-evaluation or otherwise evaluation.
2. Also, observe whether your feeling of respect is based on treating the other as you would treat yourself or on differentiations based on body, physical facilities or beliefs.

Expected outcome: The students are able to see that respect is actually the right evaluation, and only right evaluation leads to fulfillment in relationship. Many present problems in the society are an outcome of differentiations (lack of correct understanding of respect), like gender bias, generation gap, caste conflicts, class struggle, domination through power, communal violence, clash of interests, and so on. All these problems can be solved by realizing that the other is like me. The other also has the same natural acceptance, potential and program to ensure a happy and prosperous life for him and for others though he may have differences in body, physical facilities or beliefs.

PS 9:

1. Write a narration in the form of a story, poem, skit or essay to clarify a salient Human Value to the children.
2. Recollect and narrate an incident in your life where you were able to exhibit willful adherence to values in a difficult situation.

Contd...

Expected outcome: The students are able to use their creativity for clarifying about Human Values in a simple manner and communicating with children in this respect. Also they are encouraged to introspect on their own behaviour in context with Human Values.

Module 4: Harmony in the Nature (Existence)

PS 10: List down some common units (things) of Nature which you come across in your daily life and classify them in the four orders of Nature. Analysis and explain the aspect of mutual fulfillment of each unit with other orders.

Expected outcome: The students are able to differentiate between the characteristics and activities of different orders existing in Nature and study the mutual fulfillment among them. Their attention is also drawn towards the expected role of human beings in mutual fulfillment with all the orders of Nature.

PS 11: Make a chart to show the whole existence as co-existence. With the help of this chart try to identify the role and the scope of some of the courses of your study. Also indicate the areas which are being either over-emphasized or ignored in the present context.

Expected outcome: The students are able to obtain a Holistic vision about existence and in the light of this understanding they are able to place various educational inputs appropriately.

Module 5: Implications of the Holistic Understanding – a Look at Professional Ethics

PS 12: Identify any two important problems being faced by the society today and analyze the root cause of these problems. Can these be solved on the basis of natural acceptance of human values. If so, how should one proceed in this direction from the present situation?

Expected outcome: The students are able to clearly visualize the co-relation between lack of Human Values and the prevailing problems. They are also able to visualize tangible steps and a roadmap for moving in the cherished direction.

PS 13:

1. Suggest ways in which you can use your knowledge of Science/Technology/Management etc. for moving towards a universal human order.
2. Propose a broad outline for Humanistic Constitution at the level of Nation.

Expected outcome: The students are able to visualize an appropriate utilization of the knowledge in their respective streams to ensure mutually enriching and sustainable systems.

PS 14: The course is going to be over now. It is time to evaluate what difference in your thinking has it made. Summarize the core message of this course grasped by you. How has this affected you in terms of;

a. Thought

b. Behavior

c. Work and

d. Realization

What practical steps are you able to visualize for the transition of the society from its present state.

Expected outcome: The students are able to sincerely evaluate the course and the transformation achieved in this process. They are also able to make use of this understanding for moving towards a happy and prosperous life including an ethical conduct of their profession.

Glossary

Note:

1. The words used in this book have a definite meaning which is the reality in the existence. Some of the words and the associated meanings are given below. It is important to refer to these meanings (realities) while reading/using these words.

2. The words and meanings provided below are translations from the original Hindi (provided in italics in the table below). These words have been taken from the reference books listed (ref. 1 to 5).

Word	Meaning	Hindi equivalent
Activity	(1) Units are active, they have activity. (2) Activities can be: physical-activity, chemical-activity & conscious (*jïvana*)-activity.	*Kriyã*
Activity Completeness	– All ten activities in the Self (*jïvana*, 'I') expressing themselves upon having the realization (*anubhava*).	*Kriyã pürṇatã*
Affection	(1) The feeling of being related to the other in relationship – the feeling that the other is my relative. (2) Spontaneity in behavior, for mutual fulfillment.	*Sneha*
Animal Consciousness	(1) Living of human being only on the basis of physical facilities, and *not* with right understanding and relationship. (2) Living with assumption for oneself as body.	*Jïva chetanã*
Animal Order	– Animals and birds, having will to live.	*Jïva avasthã*
Art	– Human-abilities for helping and preserving utility of a physical entity	*Kalã*

Contd...

Assuming	– Activity of the Self (*jïvana,* 'I') as in 'knowing, assuming, recognizing & fulfilling'. One can know and assume, or only live on the basis of assumptions, without knowing	*Mãnanã*
Behavior	– Acceptance of relationship with human beings and its fulfillment ensuring justice.	*Vyavahãra*
Bliss	(1) Realization (*anubhava*) followed by understanding (*bodha*) (2) Living with realization and authenticity.	*Ãnanda*
Bravery	(1) Being assured that the all encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all levels and I am ready to help the other have the right understanding. (2) This is the commitment to help the other have the right understanding of and live in harmony at all levels of existence.	*Viratã*
Character	– Living with one's own wealth (produced by efforts on nature), conjugality in marital relationship and kindness in behavior and work.	*Charitra*
Contemplation	– Activity in Self (*jïvana*, 'I') that expresses the faculty of desiring.	*Chitta*
Co-existence	(1) Existence is in the form of co-existence which is nature (all material entities and conscious entities) submerged in space. (2) To be related, to be in harmony.	*Sah-astitva*
Consciousness	(1) Self ('I') or *jïvana.* (2) Ability for knowing, assuming, recognizing and fulfilling.	*Chaitanya*
Consciousness Development	– Qualitative change in consciousness from one plane to the other: from animal consciousness to human consciousness	*Chetanã vikãs*
Conduct Completeness	(1) Living with humane conduct and its continuity. (2) Activity completeness (realization & understanding) followed by authenticity in behaviour and work.	*Ãcharaṇ pürṇatã*
Cruelty	– The feeling that I cannot take care of my body and hence I resort to forcefulness and violence.	*Krüratã*
Cyclic production	(1) Actualizing prosperity by production ensuring sustenance of resources required for it. (2) Production systems which are cyclic and close ended as present in nature.	*Ãvartanshïla utpãdana*

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Desire	– Activity of Self (*jïvana*, 'I') of imaging.	*Ichchhã*
Education	(1) Imparting right understanding and skill. (2) Imparting knowledge required for humane-behavior and humane-occupation.	*Shikshã*
Ethics	(1) Living with right understanding, with knowledge. (2) Behavior based on humane conduct, only possible when living with human consciousness, with the right understanding.	*Naitikatã*
Established Values (in relationship)	– Values in human-human relationship: Trust, Respect, Affection, Care, Guidance, Reverence, Glory, Gratitude, Love.	*Sthãphita mülya*
Existence	(1) All that exists. (2) To be. (3) Nature submerged in all-pervading space.	*Astitva*
Realization	(1) Realizing existence as co-existence, as units submerged in space. (2) Knowing by a human being of existence in its entirety.	*Anubhava*
Expectation	(1) Wanting to live with happiness (2) Power in Self (*jeevan*, 'I') for selection/taste	*Ãshã*
Family	– Group of individuals living in relationship of mutual fulfillment ensuring right understanding and prosperity.	*Parivãra*
Fearlessness	– Mutual Trust and Complementariness.	*Abhaya*
Generosity	– Readiness to invest oneself, one's body and wealth to help the other have the right understanding and live accordingly.	*Udãratã*
Glory	– The feeling for someone who has made efforts for excellence and its emulation.	*Gaurava*
Gratitude	(1) The feeling for someone who has made efforts for my excellence. (2) Acceptance of help received from anyone for ensuring right understanding and living in me.	*Kritagyatã*
Guidance	– The feeling of ensuring right understanding and feelings in the other (my relative).	*Vãtsalya*
Happiness	(1) The state/situation I am in , if there is harmony/synergy in it, I like being in that state. To continue to be in a state of liking is happiness. To be in harmony is happiness.	*Sukha*

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	(2) Living with all-encompassing solution. (3) Harmony in expectation and thought.	
Health	(1) The Body acts according to the Self. (2) There is harmony between the parts of the Body.	*Svãsthya*
Human Consciousness	(1) Living with all three:- right understanding, relationship and physical facilities. (2) Living with views of justice, resolution, and truth. (3) Understanding human being as co-existence of Self (*jïvana*, 'I') and Body.	*Mãnava chetanã*
Human Goal	– Right understanding, prosperity, fearlessness, and co-existence.	*Mãnava lakshya*
Human Being	– Coexistence of Self (*jïvana*, 'I') and human body.	*Mãnava*
Humane conduct	– Combined expression of human-values, humane policy and humane-character.	*Mãnavïya ãcharaṇa*
Humane Society	– Tradition of fulfillment of comprehensive human goal in society through five dimensions of universal human order from family to world family.	*Mãnavïya samãja*
Humane Tradition	(1) Human beings living with fulfillment of comprehensive human goal. (2) Humane conduct, education, constitution and universal human order, its continuity.	*Mãnavïya paramparã*
Human Values	– Perseverance, Bravery, Generosity, Kindness, Beneficence, Compassion.	*Mãnava mülya*
Innateness	(1) The innateness of a unit. (2) That which is inseparable from a unit.	*Dhãraṇã , dharma*
Knowing	(1) Having the right understanding from Self (*jïvana*, 'I') to entire existence. (2) Having knowledge of Self (*jïvana*, 'I'), knowledge of existence and knowledge of humane conduct.	*Jãnanã*
Knowledge	(1) Having the right understanding of reality. (2) Knowledge of Self (*jïvana*, 'I'), knowledge of existence and knowledge of humane conduct.	*Gyãna*
Love	(1) The feeling of being related to every unit in existence. (2) Complete value in human-human relationship	*Prema*

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	(4) Combined expression of kindness, beneficence, and compassion.	
Material Order	– Physico-chemical units – i.e. soil, stone, gems, and metals in the form of solid, liquid, and gaseous matter.	*Padãrtha avasthã*
Care	– The feeling of responsibility for nurture and protection of the body of the other.	*Mamatã*
Mutual Fulfillment	– To be related in a mutual complementarity, not to be in conflict.	*Paraspara pürakatã*
Mutual	– Togetherness of more than one entity.	*Parasparatã*
Natural Acceptance	(1) That which is innate to the human being. (2) Reflection of co-existence in the Self (*jeevan*, 'I').	*Sahaja svïkriti*
Natural Characteristic	– Participation in the larger order – that is natural to the entity.	*Svabhãva*
Nature	(1) Innumerable set of material units and conscious units. (2) Collection of units – in four orders : material-order, pranic/bio- order, animal-order and human-order.	*Prakriti*
Peace	(1) Definiteness of Thought based on definiteness of Desire of Self (*jïvana*, 'I'). (2) Harmonious thought.	*Sãnti*
Space	(1) All-pervading reality. (2) Equilibrium energy in which every material and conscious unit is submerged.	*Vyãpaka*
Perseverance	– Being assured that the all-encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all levels of existence, living with this commitment without any perturbation.	*Dhïratã*
Profession	(1) Participation in the larger order, in the form of behavior and work. (2) To profess what one knows – in human consciousness with the right understanding.	*Vyavasthã mein bhãgïdãrï*
Plant order	(1) Composition of respiring-cells as vegetations and its kinds. (2) Vegetation. (3) Traditions of seed-inheritance.	*Prãṇa avasthã*
Prosperity	(1) The feeling of having or producing more than required physical facilities.	*Samriddhi*

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	(2) Absence of feelings of not-having the required resources for living. (3) Efforts by a family resulting in more production than its needs for the nurture, protection and right utilization of the body, and for its participation in human-organization.	
Reality	(1) All that exists. (2) Unit with its aspects of appearance, qualities, natural-characteristics, and innateness in space.	*Vastu*
Right Utilization	(1) The utilization of a physical facility in fulfilling the comprehensive human goal. (2) Activities of extending and offering one's resources (body, mind, and wealth) in fulfilling human values.	*Sadupayoga*
All-encompassing solution	(1) Right understanding. (2) Absence of problems in the Self. (3) Completion of activities of Knowing, Assuming, Recognizing, and Fulfilling (4) Answer for why and how. (5) All-encompassing solution = Human innateness (*dharma*) = Happiness.	*Samãdhãna*
Respect	(1) Right Evaluation of the other in relationship. (2) Continuous acceptance of talent and personality in other human being.	*Sammãna*
Right Understanding	– Understanding of harmony at four levels of living from Self to entire existence.	*Samajhadãrï, Samãdhãna*
Reverence	– The feeling of acceptance of excellence in the other and spontaneous effort towards it.	*Shraddhã*
Satisfaction	(1) Desire being in harmony with the understanding in Self (*jïvana*, 'I'). (2) Definiteness of desire based on understanding in the Self and assurance of its fulfillment.	*Santoṣa*
Self ('I')	(1) Conscious entity. Human being is co-existence of the Self (*jïvana*, 'I') and Body. (2) Exhibits knowing, assuming, recognizing & fulfilling.	*Jïvana*
Self-regulation	(1) Self regulation – concerning the body. (2) The feeling of being responsible to the Body for its nurture, protection and right utilization.	*Sanyama*

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Skills	Techniques to work with the rest of nature and to express feelings through behavior.	*Dakshatā*
Trust	(1) Having assurance on the intention of the other – that the other wants to make me happy at all times. (2) Acceptance of values innate in a relationship.	*Viśvāsa*
Values	(1) Self-Values, Human-Values, Established-Values, Expressed-Values, Utility-Values, and Artistic-Values. (2) Participation in the larger order.	*Mülya*
Values in Self (I)	Happiness, Peace, Satisfaction, and Bliss.	*Jivana mülya*
Work	(1) Interaction of human being with the rest of nature. (2) Production for ensuring prosperity.	*Kārya*
Wisdom	– Potential in Self (*jivana*,'I') for understanding (*bodha*).	*Buddhi*

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(Note: The Teacher's Manual for this course is also available with M/s Excel Books, New Delhi.)